דּוֹבֵר צֶדֶק

Dover Tzedek

לִקּוּטִים

Likutim

וַיֵּשֶׁב • עֲבוֹדָה זָרָה • אַחֲרֵי מוֹת

Vayeishev • Avodah Zarah • Acharei Mos

Volume II

Interlinear Translation with Annotated Footnotes

Akiva Publishing · 2026

Dover Tzedek

Interlinear Translation with Annotated Footnotes · Volume Two · Vayeishev, Avodah Zarah, Acharei Mos

This volume presents, in elucidated bilingual form, Vayeishev, Avodah Zarah, Acharei Mos. The original publisher’s title-page material appears in Volume I, Hebrew paragraph followed by English.

The Hebrew text of the author is presented with full vocalization (nikkud), followed by a close English rendering in bold and an interwoven elucidation in scholarly register. Talmudic, Midrashic, Zoharic, and cross-textual sources are supplied in the footnotes, together with parallel passages from R' Tzadok's broader corpus.

Methodological note: This edition was prepared with the assistance of AI tools for drafting, translation, and formatting. Textual difficulties and editorial readings are identified in the notes; readers are encouraged to consult the underlying Hebrew of the original Dover Tzedek directly. References to Akiva Publishing editions use their own paragraph divisions, which may differ from those of other editions.

Original work Dover Tzedek by Rabbi Tzadok HaKohen Rabinowitz of Lublin (1823–1900).

Elucidation, translation, vocalization, and annotations © 2026 Akiva Publishing. All rights reserved. No part of this publication may be reproduced, stored in a retrieval system, or transmitted in any form or by any means — electronic, mechanical, photocopying, recording, or otherwise — without the prior written permission of the publisher.

Published by Akiva Publishing · First Edition, 2026

Vayeishev — Section 2

Yaakov Sought Tranquility; Murder and Adultery as the Roots of All Evil

ב׳. "וַיֵּשֶׁב יַעֲקֹב" — בִּקֵּשׁ לֵישֵׁב בְּשַׁלְוָה, קָפַץ עָלָיו רִגְזוֹ שֶׁל יוֹסֵף.[1] **— Section 2: "And Jacob dwelt" (Genesis 37:1) —he sought to dwell in tranquility, whereupon the agitation of Joseph pounced upon him (Bereishit Rabbah 84:3).** כִּי יָדוּעַ דְּ"לֹא תִרְצָח" וְ"לֹא תִנְאָף" הֵם אֵבוֹת כָּל הַמִּדּוֹת רָעוֹת, וְכוֹלְלִים כָּל הָרַע שֶׁבָּעוֹלָם.[2] [3] **— For it is known that murder and adultery—the evils prohibited by "You shall not murder" and "You shall not commit adultery" (Exodus 20:13)—are the roots of all evil character traits and encompass all the evil in the world.** וְהֵם סַמָּאֵ״ל וְנָחָשׁ הַיְדוּעִים בַּזֹּהַר כַּמָּה פְּעָמִים: סַמָּאֵ״ל — שָׁרוֹ שֶׁל עֵשָׂו שֶׁהוּא רְצִיחָה, וְהָרְצִיחָה — בִּזְכוּרָא, וְנִיאוּף בִּנוּקְבָא כִּידוּעַ בְּכָל מָקוֹם. **— And they correspond to Samael and the Serpent frequently noted in the Zohar: Samael is the guardian angel of Esau, embodying bloodshed, where murder belongs to the male aspect and adultery to the female aspect, as is universally recognized.** וְהִיא נָחָשׁ מְקַדְּמֵיתָּ דְּסַמָּאֵ״ל, אִשָּׁה זוֹנָה שֶׁכָּל שִׂיחָתָהּ אֵינוֹ אֶלָּא נִיאוּף כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ חֲכָמֵינוּ זִכְרוֹנָם לִבְרָכָה. **— And she is the Serpent preceding Samael, the depraved harlot whose entire discourse revolves solely around adulterous lust, as our Sages taught.** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב: רָאָה אוֹתָן עֲסוּקִין בְּדֶרֶךְ אֶרֶץ וְנִתְאַוָּה לָהֶם, וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב שָׁכַב עַל חַוָּה וְהִטִּיל בָּהּ זוּהֲמָא.[4] [5] **— And as written: he observed them engaged in marital relations and lusted after them (Bereishit Rabbah 18:6), and as stated: he came upon Eve and injected moral defilement (*zuhama*) into her (Shabbat 146a).**

[וְלָכֵן אִיתָא סוֹף פֶּרֶק קַמָּא דְּבָבָא קַמָּא (דַּף ט״ז עַמּוּד א׳): שִׁדְרוֹ שֶׁל אָדָם הוֹפֵךְ לְאַחַר שֶׁבַע שָׁנִים נַעֲשֶׂה נָחָשׁ.[6] **— [And therefore it is taught at the end of the first chapter of Bava Kamma (16a): a man's spinal column turns into a serpent after seven years.** שִׁדְרָה הוּא מַהֲלַךְ טִפֵּי הַזֶּרַע מִן הַמֹּחַ לַגִּיד, וְשָׁם הַתַּאֲוָה, וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ חֲכָמֵינוּ זִכְרוֹנָם לִבְרָכָה (בְּרָכוֹת דַּף י״ג עַמּוּד ב׳): שֶׁלֹּא יִישַׁן פְּרַקְדָּן.[7] **— The spine serves as the conduit of generative seed descending from the brain to the organ, where lust resides, matching the Sages' admonition (Berakhot 13b) not to sleep flat on one's back.** וּלְכָךְ נַעֲשֶׂה נָחָשׁ — דַּרְגָּא דִּילֵיהּ דְּאָחִיד בֵּיהּ, וּבִלְבַד דְּלָא כָּרַע בְּ"מוֹדִים".[8] **— Therefore it becomes a serpent—the spiritual level to which he has attached himself—provided that he did not bow at "Modim."** שֶׁנִּנָּהָפְכוּ חֲלִיּוֹת שֶׁבִּשִּׁדְרָה וְנַעֲשׂוּ מֶרְכָּבָה לַעֲבוֹדַת הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ, וְאִי אֶפְשָׁר עוֹד לִהְיוֹת מִשָּׁכֵן לָרַע כְּלָל, וּכְמוֹ

---

[1] **Bereishis Rabbah 84:3**: 'Because our father Jacob sought to dwell tranquilly in this world, Joseph's adversary confronted him. "Jacob dwelt"—"I had no ease and no quiet." No ease from Esau, no quiet from Laban, no rest from Dinah; "then turmoil came"—the turmoil concerning Joseph came upon me.'

[2] **Kisvei Rav Tzadok — Machshavot Charutz 13:5**: "And all kinds of evil in the world have their root in anger and desire, against which is the warning "You shall not murder" and "You shall not commit adultery" (Exodus 20:13); and the root of their root is "I am" and "You shall have no other" (there 20:2–3)."

[3] **Exodus 20:13**: 'You shall not murder. You shall not commit adultery. You shall not steal. You shall not bear false witness against your fellow.'

[4] **Bereishis Rabbah 18:6**: 'Rabbi Yehoshua ben Korchah said: To inform you through what sin that wicked one leapt upon them: because he saw them engaged in marital relations and desired her.'

[5] **Shabbos 146a**: 'When the serpent came upon Chavah it cast contamination into her. Israel, who stood at Mount Sinai—their contamination ceased; the nations, who did not stand at Mount Sinai—their contamination did not cease.'

[6] **Bava Kamma 16a**: 'A person's spine, after seven years, becomes a snake. And this applies only when he did not bow at "Modim."'

[7] **Berachos 13b**: 'Rav Yosef said: One lying on his back may not recite the Shema. Reciting he may not, but sleeping is permitted? But Rabbi Yehoshua ben Levi cursed one who sleeps on his back!'

[8] **Tzidkat HaTzadik 233:1** (excerpt): 'As for "I am grateful to my head," and so forth: a foreign thought arises at Modim through envy, for Modim is thanksgiving for God's kindnesses. The envious person feels deficient and does not thank God for His benefits; on the contrary, he complains that God gives good to his fellow. This is what they said in Bava Kamma 16a about a person's spine, and that this applies when he did not bow at Modim: "Envy is the rotting of the bones." The serpent's root is envy, as our sages said that it saw and became envious. Likewise, Chavah's giving the food to Adam was motivated by envy.' Tzidkat HaTzadik explains the ethical content of bowing at Modim. Gratitude acknowledges the good received, while envy resents the good given to another. The bodily bow in Dover Tzedek thus participates in the rectification of the serpent's root, rather than remaining an external motion.

שֶׁאָמְרוּ חֲכָמֵינוּ זִכְרוֹנָם לִבְרָכָה: שְׁמִי מֵעִיד בָּהֶם. — **But through bowing, the vertebrae of the spine are sanctified into a vehicle for the service of Hashem, incapable of serving as a resting place for evil, matching the tradition: "My Name testifies over them."** וּבְמָקוֹם אַחֵר: כִּי אָבוֹת וְהוֹדָאָה הֵם הַתְחָלָה וְסוֹף — אָבוֹת וּמָשִׁיחַ.[9] — **And explained elsewhere: the blessing of the Patriarchs (*Avot*) and Thanksgiving (*Hoda'ah*) represent beginning and end—the Patriarchs and the Messiah.**

וּבִרְכַּת הוֹדָאָה הוּא נֶגֶד מָשִׁיחַ, שֶׁאָז הוּא: יוֹדוּ כָּל בָּאֵי עוֹלָם לְהַשִּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ. — **And the blessing of Thanksgiving corresponds to the Messiah, when all inhabitants of the world will gratefully acknowledge Hashem, Blessed be He.** וְלָכֵן אַחַר כָּךְ "שִׂים שָׁלוֹם", שֶׁהוּא בָּא לַעֲשׂוֹת שָׁלוֹם בָּעוֹלָם, וְעַל יְדֵי זֶה נִתְקַן חֵטְא נָחָשׁ, שֶׁהוּא בָּא לְתַקֵּן חֵטְא דְּנָחָשׁ בָּאָדָם כַּנּוֹדָע. — **Wherefore it is followed by the prayer for peace (*Sim Shalom*), as he arrives to establish universal peace, thereby rectifying the primal sin of the Serpent introduced into mankind.**

וְשֶׁבַע שָׁנִים הוּא כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בִּבְכוֹרוֹת (דף ח' עמוד ב'): דְּעִבּוּרוֹ שֶׁל נָחָשׁ שֶׁבַע שָׁנִים.[10] — **And the seven-year span matches Bekhorot (8b): the gestation of a serpent lasts seven years.** וְשִׁעוּר זֶה הוּא סֵדֶר בִּנְיַן שֶׁל כָּל דָּבָר בְּמִסְפַּר שִׁבְעָה כַּנּוֹדָע, וְחָסֵר שֶׁלֹּשׁ רֹאשׁוֹנוֹת. — **And this measurement reflects the architectural structure of every completed level structured in the number seven, lacking the three supreme intellectual crowns.** כִּידוּעַ דְּקוֹמַת הָאִשָּׁה קְטַנָּה מִקּוֹמַת הָאִישׁ כְּשִׁעוּר הָרֹאשׁ, שֶׁהוּא שָׁלֹשׁ הָרֹאשׁוֹנוֹת. — **For as is known, the spiritual height of the female is lower than that of the male by the height of the head, which comprises the three higher Sefirot.** [וְהָיְנוּ כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב: דְּרֵישֵׁהּ דְּעֵשָׂו בְּעִטְפֵּיהּ דְּיִצְחָק, וְלֹא הָיָה לוֹ יְנִיקָה מִן הָרֹאשׁ. — **Matching the Midrashic tradition: the severed head of Esau was enveloped within the lap of Isaac (Pirkei De-Rabbi Eliezer 39), possessing no sustenance from the exalted head].**

The Ten Nations; Edom in Murder, Amon and Moav in Adultery

וְנֶגְדָּם בִּקְדֻשָּׁה: יַעֲקֹב, רָחֵל, וְלֵאָה. — **And corresponding to them on the side of holiness stand Jacob, Rachel, and Leah.** וְהַנָּשִׁים חֲלוּקִים לִשְׁנַיִם, וְהַיְנוּ כִּידוּעַ דַּעֲשָׂרָה עֲמָמִין הִבְטִיחַ הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא וְלֹא נָטְלוּ רַק שִׁבְעָה. — **And the matriarchs are divided into two archetypes, paralleling the ten Canaanite nations promised by the Holy One of which Israel conquered only seven.** וְהַשְּׁלֹשָׁה אָמְרוּ חֲכָמֵינוּ זִכְרוֹנָם לִבְרָכָה בְּבָבָא בַּתְרָא (דַּף נ"ו עמוד א') שֶׁהֵם: אֱדוֹם, עַמּוֹן, וּמוֹאָב, וְעָתִיד הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא לִתְּנָם לָעָתִיד לָבוֹא.[11] — **And the remaining three, as the Sages taught in Bava Batra (56a), are Edom, Ammon, and Moab, which the Holy One is destined to grant to Israel in the Messianic era.** וְהַיְנוּ דְּיָדוּעַ דְּשִׁבְעָה עֲמָמִין הֵם שֶׁבַע תַּחְתּוֹנוֹת דִּקְלִפָּה, שֶׁהֵם כְּלַל כָּל הַמִּדּוֹת רָעוֹת, וְזָכוּ יִשְׂרָאֵל בְּמַתַּן תּוֹרָה וְנִצְּחוּם. — **For it is known that the seven nations correspond to the seven lower Sefirot of the husk (*kelipah*) representing the sum of all evil character traits, which Israel subdued upon receiving the Torah.** אֲבָל הַשָּׁלֹשׁ רֹאשׁוֹנוֹת לֹא נִצְּחוּ עֲדַיִן עַד לֶעָתִיד, וְהֵם אָבוֹת הַכּוֹלְלוֹת כָּל הָרָעוֹת, שֶׁהֵם אֱדוֹם בְּרִצְיָחָה כִּידוּעַ, וְעַמּוֹן וּמוֹאָב בְּנִיאוּף, שֶׁמִּשָּׁם מְקוֹרָם מִזְּנוּת, וְהוּא נִתְכַּוֵּן לְדָבָר עֲבֵרָה. — **But the three supernal heads were not yet vanquished until the Future; they are the supreme roots of all wickedness: Edom in bloodshed, and Ammon and Moab in illicit lust, whose very genesis stemmed from incestuous harlotry with transgressive intent.** וְאָמְרוּ חֲכָמֵינוּ זִכְרוֹנָם לִבְרָכָה: כָּל הַמִּקְרָא כֻּלּוֹ עַל שֵׁם זְנוּת

---

[9] **Kisvei Rav Tzadok — Kometz HaMinchah 2:32:1**: ""You shall be a blessing"—with you they conclude the blessing. So too with King David, as the Sages taught. Abraham is the beginning of creation: only the three patriarchs are called fathers, for they are the fathers of the world and the beginning of recognition of divinity; Abraham is father of them all. "A father of a multitude of nations" includes the title father in his name, for fatherhood means expansion into branches, the quality of kindness and expansion. The Zohar says that the father founded the daughter, as I have written elsewhere: Abraham, Isaac, Jacob and David are father, mother, son and daughter. The final deed is in the first thought, for King David, who is the Messiah, is the end of creation. Therefore concluding the blessing with him relates back to the first thought."

[10] **Bechoros 8b**: 'The Caesar said to Rabbi Yehoshua ben Chananyah: For how long is a snake pregnant before it gives birth? He said to him: Seven years.'

[11] **Bava Basra 56a**: 'To exclude the Keini, the Kenizi and the Kadmoni.… Rabbi Yehudah says: Mount Seir, Ammon and Moav.'

נֶאֱמַר.[12] **— And the Sages observed: that entire biblical narrative of their birth is framed through the lens of harlotry.** וְאָמְרוּ חֲכָמֵינוּ זִכְרוֹנָם לִבְרָכָה (בְּמִדְבַּר רַבָּה פָּרָשָׁה כ״א): הַמַּחֲטִיאוֹ יוֹתֵר מִן הַהוֹרְגוֹ וְכוּלֵי, שְׁשְׁנֵיהֶם עַמּוֹן וּמוֹאָב הָיוּ הַמַּחֲטִיאִים בְּנֵיאוּף בַּמִּדְבָּר.[13] **— And the Sages taught in Bemidbar Rabbah (21:4): one who causes another to sin is worse than one who slays him, for both Ammon and Moab seduced Israel into adulterous idolatry at Shittim.**

אֶבָל לֹא יָכְלוּ, כִּי הַמַּחֲטִיאִים הָיָה בְּנוּקְבָא, וּבְאֻמָּת נְקֵבוֹתֵיהֶם מֻתָּרוֹת מִיָּד. **— Yet their evil was not absolute, because the seduction was wrought through females, and the females of those nations were immediately permitted to convert and enter the congregation.** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ חֲכָמֵינוּ זִכְרוֹנָם לִבְרָכָה: שֶׁהֵם נִתְכַּוְּנוּ לִדְבָר מִצְוָה בְּבִנוֹת לוֹט, וְכֵן בְּזַרְעָם אַחֲרֵיהֶם.[14] **— Matching the Sages' teaching: the daughters of Lot acted with virtuous intentions to preserve humanity (Nazir 23b), a seed of purity that persisted in their female descendants.** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתַב הָאַרִ״י זִכְרוֹנוֹ לִבְרָכָה: כִּי בָּזְבִּי הִיא דִּינָה.[15] **— And as the Ari wrote: Cozbi the Midianite princess was a reincarnation of Dinah.** וּבֶאֱמֶת לֹא טָעוּ יִשְׂרָאֵל כְּלָל, כִּי שָׁקְלְטוּ מֵהֶם קְדֻשָּׁה גְּדוֹלָה, כִּי הָרֵיחוּ בָּהֶם קְדֻשַּׁת מָשִׁיחַ שֶׁהוּא בְּעַמּוֹן וּמוֹאָב כַּנּוֹדָע, וְאֵין כָּאן מְקוֹמוֹ.[16] **— And in truth Israel was drawn because they absorbed a sublime holiness, sensing the latent sanctity of the Messiah embedded within Ammon and Moab, though this is not its place.** כִּי בֶּאֱמֶת יֵשׁ בַּתַּאֲוָה גַּם כֵּן מַה שֶּׁהוּא דְּבַר מִצְוָה, וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בַּמִּדְרָשׁ הַנֶּעְלָם: שֶׁלֹּא יִתְבַּטֵּל גַּם כֵּן יֵצֶר הָרָע לָעָתִיד לָבֹא כְּדֵי לִפְרִיָה וּרְבִיָה. **— For in reality there exists within desire a holy spark that serves a mitzvah, as stated in the *Midrash HaNe'elam*: the urge to procreate will not be extinguished in the World to Come, preserving the generative impulse.** דִּבְלָאו הָכֵי לֹא יִהְיֶה חֲמִידוּ דְּאוֹרַיְיתָא כְּלָל. **— For without this capacity for passionate yearning, the passionate yearning for Torah (*chamidu d'orayta*) could not exist.** וְהֵינוּ כִּי הַחֶשְׁקִ, שֶׁזֶּהוּ מִצַּד הַנּוּקְבָא, בָּזֶה יֵשׁ טוֹב גַּם כֵּן. **— Namely: affective desire, which stems from the female aspect receiving and longing, contains authentic goodness.** אֲבָל הַהַשְׁפָּעָה שֶׁהוּא מִצַּד הַדְּכוּרָא, וְלֹא הַחֶשְׁקִ מִצַּד הַחִסָּרוֹן, בָּזֶה אֵין כְּלָל טוֹב, וְאֵין כָּאן מָקוֹם לְהַאֲרִיךְ בָּזֶה כִּי כְּבָר נִתְבָּאֵר אֶצְלֵנוּ בְּכַמָּה מְקוֹמוֹת. **— But ungrounded projection proceeding aggressively from the male side without the**

---

[12] **Nazir 23a**: 'Consider Lot and his two daughters. They intended a mitzvah—"The righteous walk in them"; he intended a transgression—"Sinners stumble in them." Perhaps he too intended a mitzvah? Rabbi Yochanan said: This entire verse alludes to transgression. "Lot lifted"—"His master's wife lifted"; "his eyes"—"She is pleasing in my eyes"; "he saw"—"Shechem son of Chamor saw her"; "all the plain of the Jordan"—"For a prostitute, as little as a loaf of bread"; "for it was all watered"—"I shall follow my lovers, who give me my bread and water, my wool and flax, my oil and drink."'

[13] **Bamidbar Rabbah 21:4**: 'Rabbi Shimon says: From where do we know that one who causes a person to sin is worse than one who kills him? For the killer kills him in this world, and he has a portion in the World to Come; but the one who causes him to sin kills him in this world and in the World to Come.… Two nations confronted Israel with the sword, and two with transgression.… Moav and Ammon… who confronted them with transgression, to cause Israel to sin: "An Ammonite or a Moabite shall not enter… forever" (Deuteronomy 23:4).'

[14] **Nazir 23a**: 'A parable of Lot and his two daughters with him: they, who intended it for the sake of a mitzvah—"and the righteous walk in them"; he, who intended it for the sake of transgression—"and transgressors stumble in them" (Hosea 14:10).'

[15] **Shaar Maamarei Razal, Midrashim 2:13, in the discourse on Abraham's strides**: 'Although Leah was rectified and the impurity of the first Eve was removed from her, so that she remained holy and wholly righteous, nevertheless, because of the strength of the dross that had clung to her, Dinah emerged from her. Dinah is harsh judgment, and was therefore named after judgment. She too was holy, but some hold of impurity still remained, for she had not been completely refined.… Afterward Shimon married her.… Dinah's root is in the powers of severity, harsh judgment, and therefore Shimon took her. Since she had not yet been purified … Shaul, the son of the Canaanite woman, was born from her, as the Sages said: the son of one who had relations with a Canaanite. He himself was Shelumiel ben Tzurishaddai, and he himself was Zimri ben Salu, as the Sages said in Sanhedrin. By the power of that impurity he attached himself to Kozbi. Kozbi, too, was the residue of the impurity associated with Dinah, the mother of Shaul; she was his destined partner, except that he consumed the fruit before it was ripe, for she was not yet fitting.'

[16] **Kisvei Rav Tzadok — Poked Akarim 5:10**: "And so too Dinah—her name testifies about her that she is from the side of the attribute of judgment; and therefore Yaakov withheld her from Esav, for he knew that he would desire her, since she belonged to the attribute from which he draws; but she is from the side of holiness. Nevertheless there was a hold of that Hivite serpent in her, until it was hard for her to separate. But in the end the children of Israel killed them all, and took in the holy spark that was in them and returned it to holiness, through Zimri ben Salu, as is known that she was reincarnated in Kozbi."

humble yearning of lack contains no goodness at all; and this is not the place to elaborate, as it was explained elsewhere.

Rachel and Leah, and Rus; Mashiach as the Rectification of the Serpent's Defilement

וְהֵם חֲלוּקִים לִשְׁנַיִם דִּגְמַת רָחֵל וְלֵאָה, שֶׁאָמַר: "יִתֵּן ה' אֶת הָאִשָּׁה [הַבָּאָה אֶל בֵּיתֶךָ כְּרָחֵל וּכְלֵאָה]" וְגוֹמֵר, שֶׁתִּהְיֶה כּוֹלֶלֶת שְׁנֵיהֶם.[17] — **And they are divided into two parallel archetypes mirroring Rachel and Leah, countered by Ruth, regarding whom the elders blessed: "Hashem make the woman that is come into your house like Rachel and like Leah" (Ruth 4:11), synthesizing both matriarchs.** וְהוּא בִּנְיַן מָשִׁיחַ שֶׁהוּא נֶפֶשׁ הַכּוֹלֶלֶת כָּל בֵּית יִשְׂרָאֵל, וְהוּא יוֹצֵא מִשְּׁנֵיהֶם: מֵעַמּוֹן וּמוֹאָב. — **This is the spiritual construction of the Messiah, the collective soul encompassing all Israel, issuing from both lineages: Ammon (Naamah) and Moab (Ruth).** וְכֵן רוּת כּוֹלֶלֶת עַל יְדֵי בִּרְכַּת הַזְּקֵנִים, וְהֵינוּ כִּי עִקַּר תִּקּוּן זוּהֲמַת הַנָּחָשׁ הוּא מָשִׁיחַ. — **And so Ruth synthesized both through the blessing of the elders, for the ultimate rectification of the Serpent's defilement is accomplished by the Messiah.** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ חֲכָמֵינוּ זִכְרוֹנָם לִבְרָכָה (בָּבָא בַּתְרָא דַף י״ז עַמּוּד א׳): שְׁלֹשָׁה מֵתוּ בְּעֲטָיוֹ שֶׁל נָחָשׁ, וְאֶחָד מֵהֶם יִשַׁי, שֶׁעָלָיו אָמְרוּ חֲכָמֵינוּ זִכְרוֹנָם לִבְרָכָה: בְּעָוֹן מָלֵא, אֲפִילּוּ חָסִיד שֶׁבַּחֲסִידִים.[18] — **Matching Bava Batra (17a): three died solely because of the counsel of the Serpent without personal sin, one being Jesse (David's father), of whom the Sages observed: even the most pious of the pious is born through inherent biological blemish.** רַק מָשִׁיחַ [בְּגִימַטְרִיָּה: נָחָשׁ] הוּא יְחַקֵּן זֶה, וּ"בִלַּע הַמָּוֶת" שֶׁהוּא עָטְיוֹ שֶׁל נָחָשׁ "לָנֶצַח".[19] — **Only the Messiah [whose name *Mashiach* numerically equals *Nachash* (358)] will rectify this, fulfilling: "He will swallow up death—the Serpent's counsel—forever" (Isaiah 25:8).** וּלְכָךְ יוֹצֵא מֵעַמּוֹן וּמוֹאָב, כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב: מִנִּיהּ וּבִיהּ אַבָּא, נְיזִיל בֵּיהּ נַרְגָּא, כִּי אֵין יָכוֹל לְתַקֵּן זֶה רַק מִי שֶׁהוּא בְּטָבַע כֵּן.[20] — **Therefore he emerges from Ammon and Moab, matching the adage: "from the forest itself comes the handle for the ax" (Sanhedrin 39b), for none can heal this except one rooted in that very raw nature.**

רַק שֶׁהוּא אֵינוֹ מִצַּד הַטֻּמְאָה, רַק מִצַּד הַקְּדֻשָּׁה. — **With the vital distinction that his passion stems not from impurity, but from absolute holiness.** וְהוּא מִזַּרְעָא דְּלֵאָה, כִּי לֵאָה הַבְּכִירָה הָגְמַת מוֹאָב הַבְּכִירָה, שֶׁאָמְרוּ חֲכָמֵינוּ זִכְרוֹנָם לִבְרָכָה שֶׁהִתְחִילָה, שֶׁהָיְתָה גּוֹבֶר בָּהּ הַתַּאֲוָה.[21] — **And he descends from Leah, Leah being the elder sister mirroring the elder daughter of Lot who bore Moab, who took the forward initiative through overpowering desire.** רַק רַבּוֹתֵינוּ זִכְרוֹנָם לִבְרָכָה קָרְאוּ מִצְוָה, שֶׁהֵרֵי קִדְּמַתָּה לִקְדֻשָּׁה אַרְבָּעָה דּוֹרוֹת. — **Yet our Sages designated her deed a mitzvah (Nazir 23b), for she preceded her younger sister in entering the holy royal line by four generations.** אֲבָל מִכָּל מָקוֹם אָמְרוּ בְּמָקוֹם אַחֵר שֶׁהִיא פִּרְסְמָה "מֵאָב", כִּי מִכָּל מָקוֹם זֶה מוֹשֵׁךְ חִסָּרוֹן שֶׁמִּצַּד עֹצֶם הַתַּאֲוָה מִסְתַּלֵּק הַבּוּשָׁה.[22] — **Nevertheless, the Sages noted elsewhere that she brazenly**

---

[17] **Ruth 4:11**: 'All the people at the gate and the elders said: We are witnesses. May the Lord make the woman entering your house like Rachel and Leah, who together built the house of Israel. May you achieve valor in Ephrathah and establish a name in Bethlehem.'

[18] **Bava Basra 17a**: 'The Rabbis taught: Four died through the counsel of the serpent, and these are they: Binyamin son of Yaakov, Amram the father of Moshe, Yishai the father of David, and Kilav son of David. All of them are known by tradition, except Yishai the father of David, concerning whom the verse is explicit.…'

[19] **Isaiah 25:8**: 'He will swallow up death forever, and the Lord Hashem will wipe away tears from every face.'

[20] **Rashi on Sanhedrin 39b**: 'From the forest itself comes the wood placed into the axe socket as a handle, with which the forest is cut down. Thus Obadiah acts against Edom, and David against Moab, although he descended from Ruth the Moabitess.'

[21] **Nazir 23b**: Rabbi Chiya bar Abba said in Rabbi Yochanan's name: 'How do we know that God withholds not even the reward for refined speech? Concerning the elder daughter, who called her son Moab, God said: "Do not distress Moab or provoke them to war." War is prohibited, but distressing them is permitted. Concerning the younger daughter, who called her son Ben Ammi, He said: "Do not distress or provoke them"—even distressing them is entirely prohibited.' Rabbi Chiya bar Avin said in Rabbi Yehoshua ben Korchah's name: 'A person should always hasten to perform a mitzvah. Because the elder daughter preceded the younger by one night, she merited preceding her by four generations in Israel's royal line.'

[22] **Kisvei Rav Tzadok — Peri Tzadik, Chukat 4:1**: "And Moav is the root of the shell of desire, as is stated (Bereishis Rabbah 51): whoever is eager for a craving of forbidden relations is in the end fed his own flesh; and the essence of the shell was in Moav, whom she called 'from father' (as is stated in Nazir 23b)"

publicised the incest by naming him *Moav* ("from a father"), for overwhelming passion strips away modest shame. וְכֵן לֵאָה קָדְמָה לְדַבֵּר מִצָּנְעָה וְלִקְדֻשָּׁה, וְגַם כֵּן תָּבְעָה בְּפִיהָ שֶׁהִיא הַפָּךְ הַצְּנִיעוּת. **— So too Leah stepped forward proactively for holy procreation, yet boldly solicited Jacob with her mouth, which is the antithesis of reticent modesty.** וְאָמְרוּ חֲכָמֵינוּ זִכְרוֹנָם לִבְרָכָה: יַצְאָנִית הָיְתָה, וּבְבְרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה: "כְּאִמָּהּ כְּבִתָּהּ", "אִם כֵּן עָשִׂיתָ לְאָה אִמֵּנוּ" וְכוּלֵי, עַיֵּן שָׁם.[23] [24] **— And the Sages commented (Pesachim 86a; Bereishit Rabbah 80:1): she went out boldly, and "as is the mother, so is the daughter" (Ezekiel 16:44)—applied to Dinah going out, see there.** וּלְכָךְ הָיְתָה רְאוּיָה בְּפִי מַחְשְׁבוֹת הַבְּרִיּוֹת לְעֵשָׂו. **— Wherefore by common popular reckoning she was presumed destined for Esau.**

And this was divinely justified that initial human perception should view it thus, for at first glance her raw intensity mirrored his. וְגַם זֶה בְּמִשְׁפָּט שֶׁתִּהְיֶה הַמַּשְׁכָּל רִאשׁוֹן שֶׁל בְּנֵי אָדָם כָּךְ, כִּי בֶּאֱמֶת הַמַּשְׁכָּל רִאשׁוֹן הָיָה כָּךְ. אֲבָל בֶּאֱמֶת עָמְקָהּ הָיָה "טוֹב מְאֹד" — זֶה יֵצֶר הָרָע שֶׁגַּם בּוֹ יֵשׁ "טוֹב מְאֹד", וְהוּא מַדַּת לֵאָה, וְלֹא הָיְתָה בָּהּ שׁוּם הִתְדַּבְּקוּת לָרָע כְּלָל.[25] **— Yet in truth her inner depth was "very good" (Genesis 1:31)—which the Midrash expounds as the Evil Inclination, for it harbors a hidden transcendent good; this was Leah's attribute, utterly untainted by evil.** רַק מִכָּל מָקוֹם פָּעַל בְּיוֹצְאֵי יְרֵכָהּ שֶׁהִיא דִּינָה, כִּידוּעַ דִּשְׁכֶם הוּא נָחָשׁ הַקַּדְמוֹנִי. **— Nonetheless, this external forwardness left an imprint upon her offspring Dinah, Shechem being the embodiment of the Primordial Serpent.** וּבֶאֱמֶת שְׁלִיטַת הָאָדָם בְּאָדָם לְרַע לוֹ כַּנּוֹדָע.[26] **— And truly, "man rules over man to his own detriment" (Ecclesiastes 8:9).** וּשְׁכֶם אָמַר לְיוֹשְׁבֵי עִירוֹ שֶׁהַכֹּל יִהְיֶה שֶׁלָּהֶם, וְהָיָה לְהֵיפוּךְ שֶׁהֵם לָקְחוּ הַכֹּל. **— For Shechem boasted to his townsmen that all Israel's wealth would become theirs, yet the reverse occurred and the sons of Jacob despoiled them.** וְכֵן לְעוֹלָם עִנְיַן הַחֵטְא וְעֶטְיוֹ שֶׁל נָחָשׁ שֶׁהוּא מֵהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ, כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב: "וַאֲשֶׁר הֲרַעֹתִי" (בְּרָכוֹת דַּף ל״ב עַמּוּד א׳).[27] **— And so universally with sin and the Serpent's seduction which Hashem orchestrated: "and whom I have caused evil" (Micah 4:6; Berakhot 32a).** הוּא כְּדֵי שֶׁעַל יְדֵי זֶה יִהְיֶה הַהוֹסָפוֹת לְקִלּוֹט מִתּוֹךְ הַקְּלִפָּה לְקְדֻשָּׁה כַּנּוֹדָע, וּכְטַעַם "זְדוֹנוֹת נַעֲשׂוּ זְכֻיּוֹת".[28] **— Its inner design is to extract holy sparks from the husk into the realm of sanctity, where premeditated transgressions are transformed into merits (Yoma 86b).**

Exile to Gather Converts; Shimon, Levi, and the Brothers of Dinah

— And so it is taught: Israel was exiled among the nations solely so that converts would be added to them (Pesachim 87b). וְכֵן אִיתָא: לֹא גָלוּ יִשְׂרָאֵל אֶלָּא כְּדֵי שֶׁיִּתְוַסְּפוּ עֲלֵיהֶם גֵּרִים (פְּסָחִים דַּף פ״ז עַמּוּד ב׳).[29] וְהֵם חָשְׁבוּ:

---

[23] **Bereishis Rabbah 80:1**: '"Behold, everyone who uses proverbs will use this proverb against you: As the mother, so her daughter" (Ezekiel 16:44).… They said to him: If so, was Leah our mother a harlot? He said to them: "And Leah went out to meet him" (Genesis 30:16)—she went out adorned like a harlot; therefore, "And Dinah the daughter of Leah went out" (Genesis 34:1).'

[24] **Bereishis Rabbah 80:1**: '"Dinah, daughter of Leah, went out." "Everyone who uses proverbs concerning you will say: Like mother, like daughter"... What does this mean? He replied: "A cow is not blamed until its calf kicks; a woman is not called unfaithful until her daughter is unfaithful." They asked: "Was our mother Leah then a prostitute?" He answered: "Leah went out to meet him," etc.—she went out adorned like a prostitute. Therefore, "Dinah, daughter of Leah, went out."'

[25] **Bereishis Rabbah 9:7**: '"Behold, it was very good" (Genesis 1:31)—this is the good inclination; "and behold, it was very good"—this is the evil inclination. Is the evil inclination very good? Rather, were it not for the evil inclination, a man would not build a house, marry a wife, or beget children.'

[26] **Ecclesiastes 8:9**: '…a time when man rules over man to his harm.'

[27] **Berachos 31b**: Rabbi Elazar said: 'Elijah spoke sharply toward Heaven, as it is written: "You have turned their hearts backward."' Rabbi Shmuel bar Rabbi Yitzchak said: 'How do we know that God later acknowledged Elijah's claim? It is written: "And whom I have harmed."'

[28] **Yoma 86b**: 'Reish Lakish said: Great is repentance, for through it deliberate sins become for him like merits, as it is said, "And when the wicked turns from his wickedness and does justice and righteousness, he shall live by them" (Ezekiel 33:19).… Here, [repentance] out of love; there, out of fear.'

[29] **Pesachim 87b**: 'And Rabbi Elazar said: The Holy One, blessed be He, exiled Israel among the nations only so that converts would be added to them, as it is said, "And I will sow her for Me in the land" (Hosea 2:25). Does a person sow a se'ah except to bring in many kor?'

בַּגָּלוּת הֵם יִקָּלְטוּ מִיִּשְׂרָאֵל, וְתִהְיֶה לְהֵיפוּךְ. — **And the nations imagined that in exile they would assimilate Israel, yet the opposite transpires.** וְאָמְרוּ: "מִי גָר אִתָּךְ" וְגוֹמֵר — "בְּעַנְיוּתָךְ", כִּי עִקַּר הוֹסָפוֹת גֵּרִים הוּא דַּוְקָא בְּעַנְיוּתָךְ עַל יְדֵי הַחֲטָאִים וְעָטְיוֹ שֶׁל נָחָשׁ, וְלֹא לֶעָתִיד לָבוֹא.[30] — **And the Sages expounded on Isaiah (54:15): "Whoever gathers against you shall fall for your sake"—only in your poverty are converts received, through the trials of exile, and not in the triumphant Future.** וּלְכָךְ אָמְרוּ חֲכָמֵינוּ זִכְרוֹנָם לִבְרָכָה: רֻבָּן שֶׁל עֵרֶב רַב בְּשֵׁבֶט שִׁמְעוֹן, כִּי אָמְרוּ חֲכָמֵינוּ זִכְרוֹנָם לִבְרָכָה: רֻבָּן שֶׁל כ״ד אֶלֶף דְּשִׁטִּים מִשֵּׁבֶט שִׁמְעוֹן. — **Wherefore the Sages noted that the Mixed Multitude (*Erev Rav*) was largely absorbed into the tribe of Simeon, for most of the 24,000 who fell at Shittim were from Simeon.** [וְגַם בְּמַה שֶׁאָמְרוּ לְאַנְשֵׁי שְׁכֶם: כְּשֶׁיִּמּוֹלוּ יִהְיֶה "לְעַם אֶחָד", מֵאַחַר שֶׁנִּכְתְּבוּ בַּתּוֹרָה וְאֵין זֶה שֶׁקֶר גָּמוּר, רַק מִצַּד זֶה הוּא קַבָּלַת הַגֵּרִים, אֶלָּא שֶׁהֵם לֹא נִתְגַּיְּרוּ לְשֵׁם שָׁמַיִם.[31] — **[And in their proposition to the men of Shechem that through circumcision they would become "one people" (Genesis 34:16)—since inscribed in the Torah it is not utter deceit, but the root protocol of conversion, had they converted for the sake of Heaven.**

וּלְכָךְ קַבָּלַת הָעֵרֶב רַב הָיָה עַל יְדֵי מֹשֶׁה רַבֵּנוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם מְשֻׁבָּט לֵוִי, וְהֵם נִטְּעוּ בְּתוֹךְ שֵׁבֶט שִׁמְעוֹן. — **Therefore the acceptance of the Mixed Multitude was executed by Moses our teacher of Levi, and they took root within the tribe of Simeon.** כִּי מִצַּד שְׁנֵי שְׁבָטִים אֵלּוּ נִמְשַׁךְ קַבָּלַת הַגֵּרִים בְּיִשְׂרָאֵל עַל יְדֵי דִּבְרֵיהֶם לְאַנְשֵׁי שְׁכֶם, כִּי שְׁנֵיהֶם נִקְרָאִים "אֲחֵי דִינָה" שֶׁיֵּשׁ לָהֶם שַׁיְּכוּת לָהּ. — **For through these two brothers the absorption of converts was drawn into Israel by their words at Shechem, both being called "Dinah's brothers" who shared an affinity with her.** רַק לֵוִי שֶׁנִּבְחַר לְחֶלְקוֹ שֶׁל הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ נִתְקַן וְיָצָא מִתּוֹךְ הַקְּלִפָּה לְגַמְרֵי, וּלְכָךְ לֹא נָסְבָה לֵוִי רַק שִׁמְעוֹן. וּלְכָךְ לֹא נִתְעָרְבוּ בְּלֵוִי, כִּידוּעַ דְּכֹהֲנִים וּלְוִיִּם אַדְרַבָּא מְיֻחָסִים בְּיִשְׂרָאֵל, וְהַיִּחוּס לְעוֹלָם מִצַּד נְקִיּוֹן בְּתַאֲוָה זוֹ כַּנּוֹדָע, רַק מִכָּל מָקוֹם שָׁרְשׁוֹ הוּא אֲחִי דִינָה. — **Except that Levi, chosen as Hashem's portion, was entirely rectified and extracted from the husk; wherefore Levi did not marry her, but Simeon did. Wherefore converts did not intermingle with Levi, Priests and Levites possessing the purest lineage in Israel, pedigree depending on purity in sexual desire; yet his root was Dinah's brother.**

לָכֶךְ מֹשֶׁה רַבֵּנוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם קִבֵּל הָעֵרֶב רַב, כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ חֲכָמֵינוּ זִכְרוֹנָם לִבְרָכָה עַל פָּסוּק: "עַמְּךָ הַגּוֹי הַזֶּה"[32] [33] — **Hence Moses received the Mixed Multitude, as the Sages expounded on Exodus (33:13): "this nation is your people"]** שֶׁהוּא נִכְנַס בְּעָבְיוֹ שֶׁל קוֹרָה לִשָּׂא לְדִינָה. כִּי הָיָה לוֹ שַׁיְּכוּת יוֹתֵר לָהּ, רַק שֶׁהוּא זֶרַע יַעֲקֹב שֶׁכֻּלּוֹ טוֹב וְלֹא לְתַאֲוָה כְּלָל, לְכָךְ הָיָה שׂוֹנֵא זִמָּה שֶׁל אֵמּוֹת הָעוֹלָם עוֹבְדֵי כּוֹכָבִים וּמַזָּלוֹת שֶׁכֻּלּוֹ רַע. — **wherein Simeon plunged into the thick of the fray to marry Dinah. For he shared a profound bond with her, yet being the seed of Jacob which is entirely good and free from base lust, he abhorred the licentiousness of the gentiles which is wholly corrupt.** וְעַל זֶה נֶאֱמַר: "אָפָּם כִּי עָז" (בְּרֵאשִׁית מ״ט, ז׳), שֶׁכַּעַס הוּא הִפּוּךְ מִתַּאֲוָה כִּידוּעַ.[34] — **Concerning this Jacob said: "Cursed be their anger, for it was fierce" (Genesis 49:7), wrath being the psychological antithesis of lust.** וּמִכָּל מָקוֹם אָמְרוּ חֲכָמֵינוּ זִכְרוֹנָם לִבְרָכָה: תָּמָר זְנָתָה, זִמְרִי זְנָה וְכוּ׳.[35] — **Nevertheless the Sages stated: Tamar engaged in forbidden union, Zimri engaged in forbidden**

---

[30] **Yalkut Shimoni, Isaiah 479**: ‘The Sages taught: Converts are not accepted in the messianic era. Similarly, converts were not accepted in David’s and Solomon’s days, except that some became converts attaching themselves independently.’ Rabbi Elazar asked: ‘What verse supports this? “Whoever sojourns with you shall fall to you.” One who sojourns with you in your poverty will fall to you in your prosperity.’

[31] **Genesis 34:16**: ‘Then we will give our daughters to you and take your daughters for ourselves, and we will dwell with you and become one people.’

[32] **Kisvei Rav Tzadok — Takanat HaShavin 6:41**: “And because the longing of Moshe our teacher, peace be upon him, was that the complete repair would be in his days, for he did not think it would be spoiled through the calf, therefore he accepted the converts of the mixed multitude, as there will be in the future “dragged-along converts,” although converts are not accepted in the days of Mashiach; and so he wished to repair these too.”

[33] **Exodus 33:13**: ‘And now, if I have found favor in Your eyes, let me know Your ways, that I may know You, so that I may find favor in Your eyes; and see that this nation is Your people.’

[34] **Genesis 49:7**: ‘Cursed be their anger, for it is fierce, and their wrath, for it is harsh; I will divide them in Yaakov and scatter them in Israel.’

[35] **Nazir 23b**: Ulla said: ‘Tamar engaged in illicit relations, and Zimri engaged in illicit relations. Tamar did so, and kings and prophets descended from her. Zimri did so, and many tens of thousands of Israelites fell because of him.’

union (Nazir 23b). כִּי בְּשִׁמְעוֹן עֲדַיִן אֵינוֹ מְבֹרָר בָּעוֹלָם הַזֶּה שֶׁהַכֹּל לְדָבָר מִצְוָה וְלִכְבוֹד שָׁמַיִם, רַק בִּיהוּדָה שֶׁהוּא הַמְבֹרָר כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל. — **For in Simeon it is not yet clarified in this world that all was for the sake of heaven; that clarity belongs solely to Judah who refines it as noted above.**

Yosef and David, the Two Mashiachs; the Bow That Hates Immorality, and Mashiach ben Yosef

וְהִנֵּה אָמְרוּ חֲכָמֵינוּ זִכְרוֹנָם לִבְרָכָה עַל פָּסוּק: "וַיִּגַּע בְּכַף יְרֵכוֹ" (בְּרֵאשִׁית ל״ב, כ״ו) — הַיְנוּ בְּזַרְעוֹ.[36] — **And behold, the Sages expounded on the verse: "And he touched the hollow of his thigh"—this alludes to his future descendants (Chullin 91b).** כִּי אַף עַל פִּי שֶׁיַּעֲקֹב לְעֻמַּת עֵשָׂו דְּ"זֶה לְעֻמַּת זֶה", מִכָּל מָקוֹם לְעוֹלָם הַקְּדֻשָּׁה לְמַעְלָה, וּבָהֶם בְּיַעֲקֹב וְנָשָׁיו אֵין מָקוֹם תְּפִיסָה לָרָע כְּלָל, רַק בְּזַרְעָם. — **For although Jacob stood opposite Esau as polar counterparts, holiness is ever supreme; thus within Jacob and his wives evil found no purchase whatsoever, gaining a foothold only in their descendants.** וְהַמְבָרְרִים מִזַּרְעָם נֶגֶד סַמָּאֵ״ל וְנוּקְבָא הֵם יוֹסֵף וְדָוִד, שֶׁהֵם תְּרֵין מְשִׁיחִין. — **And the redeemers from their seed appointed to vanquish Samael and his female consort are Joseph and David—the two Messiahs.** עֲמָלֵק נוֹפֵל בְּיַד זַרְעוֹ שֶׁל יוֹסֵף שֶׁהוּא נֶגֶד עֵשָׂו. — **Amalek falls specifically into the hand of Joseph's seed, who directly confronts Esau.** וְלָכֵן אָמְרוּ (מַכּוֹת דַּף י׳ עַמּוּד א׳): בְּשֶׁכָּם שְׁכִיחֵי רוֹצְחִים, וְכֵן בְּגִלְעָד, וּשְׁנֵיהֶם חֶלְקוֹ שֶׁל יוֹסֵף: אֶפְרַיִם וּמְנַשֶּׁה.[37] — **Therefore the Sages said (Makkot 10a): murderers were rampant in Shechem and in Gilead—both situated in the tribal heritage of Joseph (Ephraim and Manasseh)** [שָׁם קָבְרוּ עַצְמוֹת יוֹסֵף, כִּי שָׁם מַמָּשׁ מַדְרֵגָתוֹ, שֶׁעָשׂוּ בְּנֵי יַעֲקֹב בִּרְצִיחָה עַל שִׁנְאַת הַזְּמָה, וְעַל יְדֵי כָּךְ נִכְבְּשָׁה לָהֶם, וְזֶהוּ מַדְרֵגַת יוֹסֵף. — **[there they buried the bones of Joseph, for there lay his exact spiritual rung: where the sons of Jacob slew out of fierce hatred of licentiousness, conquering the city, which embodies Joseph's spiritual stature.**

לָכֵן אָמַר: "נָתַתִּי לְךָ שְׁכֶם... בְּחַרְבִּי וּבְקַשְׁתִּי", וְדָרְשׁוּ רַבּוֹתֵינוּ זִכְרוֹנָם לִבְרָכָה עַל עִיר שְׁכֶם.[38] — **Therefore Jacob said: "I have given you one portion (*shechem*) above your brethren, which I took with my sword and with my bow" (Genesis 48:22), expounded by our Sages as the city of Shechem.** וּ"בְחַרְבִּי" רָצָה לוֹמַר רְצִיחָה, וּ"בְקַשְׁתִּי" רָצָה לוֹמַר אוֹת הַבְּרִית כַּנּוֹדָע, וְכִלְשׁוֹן רַבּוֹתֵינוּ זִכְרוֹנָם לִבְרָכָה: קַשְׁתּוֹ נִנְעֶרֶת, יוֹרֶה כַּחֵץ. — **And "my sword" signifies holy vengeance/killing, while "my bow" signifies the sign of the Covenant, matching the Talmudic phrase: his bow discharges, shooting like an arrow.** וְיָדוּעַ דְּקֶשֶׁת בְּכָל מָקוֹם רוֹמֵז לְיוֹסֵף, וְהַיְנוּ קֶשֶׁת הַשּׁוֹנֵאת זִמָּה, כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ חֲכָמֵינוּ זִכְרוֹנָם לִבְרָכָה דְּלָא רָאָה קְרִי.[39] — **And the bow everywhere alludes to Joseph, representing the bow that abhors licentiousness, as our Sages taught that he never experienced nocturnal emission.** וְכֵן לָקְחוּ לְמָשָׁל בִּיבָמוֹת (דַּף ע״ו עַמּוּד א׳): אַטּוּ כֻּלֵּי עָלְמָא יַעֲקֹב אָבִינוּ נִינְהוּ? כִּי הוּא תַּכְלִית שִׁנְאַת הַזְּמָה.[40] — **So too they framed the question in Yevamot (76a): "Is everyone like Jacob our father?" who reached the pinnacle of despising unchastity.** שֶׁלָּכֵן אָמְרוּ חֲכָמֵינוּ זִכְרוֹנָם לִבְרָכָה (תַּעֲנִית דַּף ה׳ עַמּוּד ב׳) דְּלָא מֵת כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל, דְּהַמִּיתָה הִיא מִצַּד זִמָּה וְעָטְיוֹ שֶׁל נָחָשׁ. — **Wherefore the Sages affirmed (Ta'anit 5b) that**

---

[36] **Bereishis Rabbah 77:3**: '"And he touched the hollow of his thigh" (Genesis 32:26)—he touched the righteous men and righteous women, the prophets and prophetesses, who were destined to come forth from him. And which is this? This is the generation of persecution.'

[37] **Makkos 10a**: 'As it is written, "Gilead is a city of evildoers, tracked with blood" (Hosea 6:8). What is "tracked with blood"? Rabbi Elazar said: That they would lie in wait to kill people.'
Makkos 10a: 'Abaye said: In Shechem too murderers were common, as it is written, "And as troops of robbers wait for a man, so the company of kohanim murder on the way to Shechem" (Hosea 6:9).'

[38] **Genesis 48:22**: 'I have given you one portion more than your brothers, which I took from the Amorite's hand with my sword and bow.'

[39] **Bereishis Rabbah 98:20**: Rabbi Yochanan said: 'What caused you to be excluded from the mighty ones? The arousal you experienced with your mistress.' Rav Shmuel bar Nachman said: 'The bow was stretched and returned, as it is written: "His bow remained firm." "The arms of his hands spread"—Yitzchak said: His seed dispersed and emerged through his fingernails. "From the hands of the Mighty One of Jacob"—Rabbi Huna said in Rav Mattana's name: He saw his father's image and his blood cooled.'

[40] **Yevamos 76a**: 'Abaye said: Is everyone like our father Yaakov, of whom it is written, "My strength and the first of my vigor" (Genesis 49:3), for he never saw a seminal emission in his life?'

[41] **Taanis 5b**: 'So said Rabbi Yochanan: Our father Yaakov did not die. He said to him: Was it for nothing that the eulogizers eulogized, the embalmers embalmed and the buriers buried? He said to him: I expound a verse, as it is said,

Jacob our father did not die, for death is brought about through the licentious blemish of the Serpent's seduction. וְכֵן מֹשֶׁה רַבֵּנוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם, שֶׁהוּא מִלְּגַו מַה שֶׁיַּעֲקֹב מִלְּבַר כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּרַעְיָא מְהֵימְנָא, הָיָה גַּם כֵּן שׁוֹנֵא זְמָה כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתַבְתִּי בְּמָקוֹם אַחֵר]. שְׁכִיחֵי רוֹצְחִים וְכֵן בְּגִלְעָד, וּשְׁנֵיהֶם חֶלְקוֹ שֶׁל יוֹסֵף, אֶפְרַיִם וּמְנַשֶּׁה.[42] — **And so Moses our teacher—who represents the inner core of what Jacob was externally (Ra'aya Meheimna)—likewise abhorred licentiousness, as written elsewhere]. Murderers were common there, and likewise in Gilead; both were Joseph's territory, Ephraim and Manasseh.**

רַק שֶׁהוּא דּוֹמֶה זִיו אִיקוֹנִין שֶׁלּוֹ לְאָבִיו, שֶׁהוּא הַהֵיפֶךְ מַעֲשָׂו. — **Yet Joseph's facial radiance mirrored his father's, forming the direct antithesis of Esau.** כִּי רְצִיחָה הָרָעָה הִיא שֶׁנּוֹבַעַ מִזִּמָּה, כִּי עֵשָׂו מָלֵא זִמָּה כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ חֲכָמֵינוּ זִכְרוֹנָם לִבְרָכָה, וְנוּקְבָא נָחָשׁ. — **For evil murder springs from illicit lust, Esau being immersed in lust and bound to the Serpent.** אֲבָל הָרֹאשׁ נִקְבַּר בִּמְעָרַת הַמַּכְפֵּלָה, כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ חֲכָמֵינוּ זִכְרוֹנָם לִבְרָכָה בְּסוֹטָה (דַּף י"ג עַמּוּד א').[43] — **Yet Esau's head was buried in the Cave of Machpelah (Sotah 13a).** וְהִנּוּ כִּי הָרֹאשׁ רוֹמֵז לְחָכְמָה, וְהַחָכְמָה הוּא הֵיפֶךְ זִמָּה שֶׁנִּקְרָא "רוּחַ שְׁטוּת" בְּרֵישׁ סוֹטָה.[44] — **This indicates that the head represents Chochmah, which is the antithesis of the lust designated as a "spirit of folly" (Sotah 3a).** וְכֵן אָמְרוּ זִכְרוֹנָם לִבְרָכָה: אַדְמוֹנִי דּוֹמֶה לְעֵשָׂו וְכוּלֵי.[45] — **And so the Sages said of David (Bereishit Rabbah 63:8): he was ruddy like Esau, yet he slew only with the sanction of the Sanhedrin.** הוּא מִצַּד הַחָכְמָה, שֶׁהוּא רִתְחָא דְּרַבָּנָן. — **Which operates through Wisdom, manifesting as the righteous zeal of scholars (*ritcha d'rabbanan*).** [וּכְמוֹ שֶׁשָּׁמַעְתִּי עַל פָּסוּק: "הֲיָדַעְתֶּם כִּי לָנוּ רָמֹת גִּלְעָד" (מְלָכִים א כ"ב, ג'), כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב: "שַׂעְרֵךְ כְּעֵדֶר [הָעִזִּים שֶׁגָּלְשׁוּ] מֵהַר גִּלְעָד"[46] [47] — **[And as I heard on the verse: "Do you know that Ramoth-gilead is ours?" (I Kings 22:3), matching: "Your hair is like a flock of goats that stream down from Mount Gilead" (Song of Songs 4:1).**

פֵּרוּשׁ: הַשְּׂעָרוֹת הֵם דִּין, מוֹרוֹת כַּעַס וּרְצִיחָה כַּנּוֹדָע, רַק מֵהַר גִּלְעָד שָׁם רְצִיחָה הַטּוֹבָה בִּרְצוֹן הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ. — **The meaning: hair symbolizes Strict Judgment (*Din*), wrath, and bloodshed, yet from Mount Gilead derives**

"And you, fear not, My servant Yaakov… for behold, I save you from afar, and your seed from the land of their captivity" (Jeremiah 30:10): it compares him to his seed—just as his seed is alive, so he is alive.'

[42] **Kisvei Rav Tzadok — Likkutei Maamarim, On Book of Joshua 13**: "Therefore Bilaam breached the boundaries of sexual morality and was promiscuous. This is called falsehood, as it says, "The bread of falsehood is sweet to a man": it is desire and pleasure lasting only a moment. Hashem, whose seal is truth, is therefore called everywhere "one who hates immorality." Moshe Rabbeinu, who embodied the entirety of the Written Torah, which is called truth as explained above, was likewise the very opposite of this desire, as I wrote elsewhere concerning "opposite Beis Peor." Therefore it says, "Avenge the vengeance upon Midian, and afterward you shall be gathered to your people": avenging those who caused immorality in Israel still belonged to the root of Moshe's soul. The Sages call a righteous person's passing "his soul came to rest," meaning that he is at peace; one seeking vengeance is not at peace, for he will neither be still nor rest until his cause is accomplished. Such was the relationship between the vengeance upon Midian and Moshe Rabbeinu's passing."

[43] **Targum Yonassan to Bereishis 50:13**: 'His sons carried him to the land of Canaan. The matter was heard by the wicked Esau, who came from Mount Geval with many legions to Hebron and would not allow Joseph to bury his father in the Cave of Machpelah. Immediately Naphtali went, ran down to Egypt, and returned that same day, bringing the deed that Esau had written for his brother Jacob concerning his portion in the Cave of Machpelah. Immediately a signal was given to Chushim the son of Dan, who took a sword and cut off the head of the wicked Esau. Esau's head rolled into the cave and came to rest in the bosom of his father Isaac. Esau's sons buried his body in the field of Machpelah. Afterward Jacob's sons buried him in the cave of the field of Machpelah, the field that Abraham had bought as a burial possession from Ephron the Hittite, opposite Mamre.'

[44] **Sotah 3a**: 'Reish Lakish said: A person does not commit a transgression unless a spirit of folly (shtus) enters him, as it is said, "If any man's wife goes astray (sisteh)" (Numbers 5:12)—tishteh is written.'

[45] **Bereishis Rabbah 63:8**: '"Ruddy"—Rabbi Abba bar Kahana said: As though he were a shedder of blood. When Shmuel saw that David was ruddy… he became afraid and said: This one too is a shedder of blood like Esav. The Holy One, blessed be He, said to him: "With beautiful eyes" (I Samuel 16:12)—Esav kills on his own authority, but this one kills by the authority of the Sanhedrin.'

[46] **I Kings 22:3**: 'And the king of Israel said to his servants: Do you know that Ramos Gilead is ours, and we are silent rather than take it from the hand of the king of Aram?'

[47] **Song of Songs 4:1**: 'Behold, you are fair, my beloved, behold, you are fair; your eyes are doves behind your veil; your hair is like a flock of goats streaming down from Mount Gilead.'

sanctified execution aligned with Hashem's Will. וְזֶה בְּקֹשׁ אַחְאָב לִכְבּוֹשׁ רָמוֹת גִּלְעָד, בָּזֶה יָדַע שֶׁיְּכַפֵּר לוֹ מַה שֶּׁהָרַג הַנְּבִיאִים שָׁהָיָה גַּם כֵּן רְצִיחָה בִּרְצוֹן הַשֵּׁם, וְלָכֵן לֹא הִצְלִיחַ שָׁם]. — **And Ahab sought to capture Ramoth-gilead so that his slaying of false prophets would atone for his murderous sins; wherefore he did not succeed there].** וְכֵן רְצִיחָה דְּיוֹסֵף הוּא לִשְׁרוֹף בֵּית עֵשָׂו, וְשׁוֹפֵךְ חֲמָתוֹ עַל הָעוֹבְדֵי כּוֹכָבִים וּמַזָּלוֹת וְלֹא עַל יִשְׂרָאֵל חַס וְשָׁלוֹם. — **So too Joseph's sword serves to consume the house of Esau, pouring out wrath upon the wicked nations and never upon Israel.** וּלְכָךְ נֶאֱמַר: "וּבְשֵׁבֶט אֶפְרַיִם לֹא בָחָר" (תְּהִלִּים ע״ח, ס״ז)[48] שֶׁיִּהְיֶה לְעוֹלָם, רַק לְפִי שָׁעָה. — **Therefore it is said: "He rejected the tribe of Ephraim" (Psalms 78:67) from enduring sovereignty, it being destined only for an appointed hour.** כִּי דָּבָר זֶה שֶׁל רְצִיחָה הַטּוֹבָה הוּא גַּם כֵּן רַק לְפִי שָׁעָה שֶׁיֵּשׁ עוֹבְדֵי כּוֹכָבִים וּמַזָּלוֹת וָרָע. — **For sanctified bloodshed is necessary only as long as idolatrous evil endures in the world.** אֲבָל לֶעָתִיד שֶׁיִּהְיֶה כֻּלּוֹ טוֹב, אֵין צָרִיךְ לִרְצִיחָה כְּלָל, רַק תַּאֲוָה יִשָּׁאֵר גַּם אָז כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל מִמִּדְרַשׁ הַנֶּעְלָם. — **But in the future, when everything will be good, there will be no need for killing at all; desire alone will remain even then, as mentioned above from Midrash HaNe'elam.**

וּלְכָךְ יֵהָרֵג מָשִׁיחַ בֶּן יוֹסֵף, כִּי הַמִּיתָה הִיא עַל יְדֵי סַמָּאֵ״ל שֶׁהוּא הָרוֹצֵחַ וּמַלְאַךְ הַמָּוֶת, וּרְצִיחָה שֶׁלּוֹ נִמְשְׁכָה עַל יְדֵי הֶסָּתַת הַנָּחָשׁ וְתַאֲוָה.[49] — **Therefore Mashiach ben Yosef will be slain (Sukkah 52a), for physical death is inflicted by Samael, the murderous Angel of Death whose power was unleashed through the Serpent's seduction of desire.** וְהַיְנוּ דְּרִצְיחָתוֹ נִמְשָׁךְ מִזִּמָּה כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל, וְיוֹסֵף הוּא נֶגְדּוֹ, רַק מִכָּל מָקוֹם הוּא דַּרְגָּא דְּשׁוֹמֵר הַבְּרִית שׁוֹנֵא זִמָּה. — **Meaning that murder stems from lust, and while Joseph opposes him as the guardian of the Covenant who despises licentiousness,** וְאַף עַל פִּי שֶׁבִּרְצִיחָתוֹ מִתְגַּבֵּר עַל רְצִיחָה דְּעֵשָׂו וְשׁוֹרְפוֹ, אֲבָל מִכָּל מָקוֹם אֵינוֹ כּוֹבֵשׁ לַנָּחָשׁ עֲדַיִן שֶׁהוּא הַזִּמָּה. — **and though he overpowers Esau's violence and burns him as straw, he does not completely conquer the Serpent of lust.** כִּי הַכְּבִישָׁה הוּא מִי שֶׁהוּא מִדַּרְגָּא דִּילֵיהּ, וְלֹא מִי שֶׁהוּא לְהֵיפוּךְ שֶׁאֵין עוֹשֶׂה כְּלָל דָּבָר זֶה, וְהַכְּבִישָׁה הוּא רַק מִי שֶׁהוּא מִתְגַּבֵּר עָלָיו. — **For conquest belongs to one who engages that specific trait and transforms it, not one who remains completely aloof from it.** וּלְכָךְ נִשְׁאָר עָטְיוֹ שֶׁל נָחָשׁ, וּמְצַדּוֹ נִמְשָׁךְ הַמִּיתָה לַגּוּף. — **Wherefore the residual blemish of the Serpent lingers, drawing death upon the physical body** [שֶׁהוּא לְבוּשׁ הָאָדָם כַּנּוֹדָע, וְשָׁם יֵשׁ תְּפִיסָה לַנָּחָשׁ בְּיוֹסֵף, שֶׁהוּא שׁוֹנֵא זִמָּה בְּעֶצֶם מִצַּד הַנֶּפֶשׁ, אֲבָל מִצַּד הַגּוּף הֲרֵי נוֹלַד מִזּוּהֲמַת הַנָּפֶשׁ בְּחַוָּה. — **[which serves as the outer garment of man, where the Serpent maintains a hold even upon Joseph, who hates unchastity in his soul, yet his physical body was born of Eve's inherited defilement.**

וּלְכָךְ נֶאֱמַר: "וַתִּתְפְּשֵׂהוּ בְּבִגְדּוֹ"[50] — פֵּרוּשׁ: מִצַּד הַלְּבוּשׁ. — **Thus Scripture states: "And she caught him by his garment" (Genesis 39:12)—meaning from the aspect of the outer physical garment.** וְכֵן אָמְרוּ חֲכָמֵינוּ זִכְרוֹנָם לִבְרָכָה: שְׁתָּפַשׂ הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא לְיָרָבְעָם בְּבִגְדּוֹ: חֲזֹר בְּךָ.[51] — **And so the Sages taught (Sanhedrin 102a): Hashem seized Jeroboam by his garment and said: Repent!** פֵּרוּשׁ: שֶׁמִּצַּד הַבֶּגֶד יַחֲזֹר, שֶׁלֹּא יִתְקַנֵּא בְּבֶן דָּוִד, כִּי הוּא מְתַקֵּן עוֹלָם, שָׁנָה, וָנֶפֶשׁ. — **Meaning that through his garment he should repent and not envy the Son of David, who rectifies World, Year, and Soul.** מַה שֶּׁאֵין כֵּן יָרָבְעָם, אַף דִּנְקְרָא "אֶפְרָתִי", וְשָׁמַעְתִּי שֶׁפֵּרוּשׁ אֶפְרָתִי[52] שׁוֹמֵר הַבְּרִית, פֵּרוּשׁ: אִישׁ נָאֶה וְלֹא מְכֹעָר, שֶׁקִּלְקוּל הַבְּרִית מְכֹעָר, וְעַל זֶה נֶאֱמַר: "הֲלוֹא כִבְנֵי כֻשִׁיִּים" וְגוֹמֵר. — **Unlike Jeroboam, who despite being called an "Ephraimite" (*Ephrati*—which signifies guarding the Covenant with handsome physical form, blemishes of the covenant being disfiguring: "Are you not as children of the Ethiopians unto Me," Amos 9:7).** אֲבָל יוֹסֵף יְפֵה תֹאַר, רַק מִכָּל מָקוֹם מִצַּד הַלְּבוּשׁ יֵשׁ תְּפִיסָה, וְעוֹלָם שָׁנָה נָפֶשׁ בּוֹ, וְצָרִיךְ לְהוֹדוֹת לְבֶן דָּוִד שֶׁהוּא יְתַקֵּן זֶה]. — **Yet Joseph was truly of handsome form; nonetheless, in the outer garment of mortality evil found a hold, requiring him to yield to the Son of**

---

[48] **Psalms 78:67**: 'He rejected the tent of Yosef, and the tribe of Ephraim He did not choose.'

[49] **Sukkah 52a**: 'This eulogy—what is its subject? Rabbi Dosa and the Rabbis disagree about it. One says: For Mashiach son of Yosef, who is killed; and one says: For the evil inclination, which is killed.'

[50] **Genesis 39:12**: 'And she caught him by his garment, saying: Lie with me; and he left his garment in her hand and fled and went outside.'

[51] **Sanhedrin 102a**: 'Rabbi Abba said: After the Holy One, blessed be He, seized Yarovam by his garment and said to him: Repent, and I and you and the son of Yishai will stroll in the Garden of Eden. He said to Him: Who will be at the head? The son of Yishai at the head. If so, I do not want it.'

[52] **Amos 9:7**: 'Are you not like the children of the Kushites to Me, children of Israel? says Hashem.'

David who will accomplish ultimate rectification].

Mashiach ben David, Who Rectifies the Serpent; the Two Kingships of Yosef and Yehuda

אֲבָל מָשִׁיחַ בֶּן דָּוִד, נֶאֱמַר: "חַיִּים שָׁאַל מִמְּךָ" וְגוֹמֵר, שֶׁהוּא הַמְתַקֵּן עוֹלָם, שָׁנָה, נֶפֶשׁ לְגַמְרֵי כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל, דְּהוּא נָגֶד הַנָּחָשׁ.[53] — **But concerning Mashiach ben David it is said: "He asked life of You, and You gave it to him" (Psalms 21:5), for he is the one who completely rectifies Space, Time, and Soul (*Olam, Shanah, Nefesh*), standing directly to rectify the damage of the Serpent.** וּלְכָךְ כָּל חֲטָאֵי דָּוִד וּשְׁלֹמֹה הָיוּ מִזְּנוּת. — **Therefore, all the apparent sins of David and Solomon revolved around illicit sexual desire.** אֲבָל בֶּאֱמֶת אֵינָם חֲטָאִים, כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ חֲכָמֵינוּ זִכְרוֹנָם לִבְרָכָה (סַנְהֶדְרִין דַּף ק״ז עַמּוּד א׳): רְאוּיָה הָיְתָה בַּת שֶׁבַע לְדָוִד וְכוּלֵי.[54] — **Yet in inward truth they were not sins at all, as our Sages taught in Sanhedrin (107a): Bathsheba was designated and destined for David from the Six Days of Creation.** וְכֵן בִּשְׁלֹמֹה הַמֶּלֶךְ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם, כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתַבְתִּי בְּמָקוֹם אַחֵר, וּכְמוֹ רְצִיחָה דְּיוֹסֵף הַכֹּל טוֹב [רַק בְּדָוִד לֹא, מַה שֶּׁכָּתַבְתִּי לְעֵיל, בַּר מִדְּאוּרְיָה הַחִתִּי, כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ חֲכָמֵינוּ זִכְרוֹנָם לִבְרָכָה (שַׁבָּת דַּף נ״ו עַמּוּד א׳), הַיְנוּ חֲטָא דִּרְצִיחָה, זֶה הוּא אֲצָלוֹ לְחֵטְא.[55] — **And so too regarding King Solomon, peace be upon him, as I wrote elsewhere, just as the warfare and killing of Joseph is completely for the good [but not so with David, as noted above: "except in the matter of Uriah the Hittite," as the Sages said (Shabbat 56a). That is, the sin of bloodshed was counted as a sin in his case.**

כִּי הוּא בֶּאֱמֶת נִקְרָא "אַדְמוֹנִי עִם יְפֵה עֵינַיִם", כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ חֲכָמֵינוּ זִכְרוֹנָם לִבְרָכָה: אֵינוֹ הוֹרֵג אֶלָּא [מִדַּעַת סַנְהֶדְרִין] וְכוּלֵי, כִּי אֵין בְּטִבְעוֹ רְצִיחָה כְּלָל, רַק לְמַרְאִית עַיִן]. — **For he was called "ruddy, with beautiful eyes," meaning he sheds blood only with the sanction of the Sanhedrin, since bloodshed is not in his inner nature at all, appearing so only externally].** וּלְכָךְ הוּא אָתֵי דַּוְקָא מֵעַמּוֹן וּמוֹאָב [מַה שֶּׁאֵין כֵּן מָשִׁיחַ בֶּן יוֹסֵף אֵין בָּא מֵאֱדוֹם], — **And therefore Mashiach ben David stems specifically from Ammon and Moab [unlike Mashiach ben Yosef who does not descend from Edom],** כִּי אֶצְלוֹ צָרִיךְ דָּבָר זֶה לִהְיוֹת קָבוּעַ וְקַיָּם גַּם לֶעָתִיד לָבוֹא כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל. — **for with him the holy rectification of desire must remain permanently established even in the World to Come, as noted above.** מַה שֶּׁאֵין כֵּן בְּיוֹסֵף דְּהוּא רַק לְפִי שָׁעָה בָּעוֹלָם הַזֶּה, אֲבָל לֶעָתִיד: "אֶפְרַיִם לֹא יְקַנֵּא אֶת יְהוּדָה" וְגוֹמֵר.[57] — **Unlike Joseph, whose role of battle is only temporary for this world, whereas in the Future: "Ephraim shall not envy Judah, and Judah shall not vex Ephraim" (Isaiah 11:13).**

וְהַקְּבִיעוּת מִדָּה זוֹ לְעוֹלְמֵי עַד הוּא שְׁתִילַת דִּרְגָּא שֶׁלּוֹ הָרָעָה לְגַמְרֵי בְּתוֹךְ הַטּוֹב. — **And making this attribute eternal means uprooting and completely grafting what was originally in the realm of raw desire into the realm of absolute holiness.** וּלְכָךְ יְהוּדָה וְיוֹסֵף שְׁנֵיהֶם מְלָכִים בָּעוֹלָם הַזֶּה, אֲבָל לֶעָתִיד: מֶלֶךְ אֶחָד לָהֶם כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל. — **Therefore both Judah and Joseph hold kingship in this world, but in the Future one single king shall rule over them both, as noted above.** וּלְכָךְ הִתְחִילָה מַלְכוּת יוֹסֵף עַל אֻמּוֹת הָעוֹלָם עוֹבְדֵי כּוֹכָבִים וּמַזָּלוֹת שֶׁהֵם רַק מִצַּד הָעוֹלָם הַזֶּה, וְעַל מִצְרַיִם בִּיחוּד, שֶׁהֵם "עֶרְוַת הָאָרֶץ", אוֹהֲבֵי זִמָּה, כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב: "כְּמַעֲשֵׂה אֶרֶץ מִצְרַיִם" וְגוֹמֵר, וְהוּא לְהֵיפֶךְ

---

[53] **Psalms 21:5**: 'Life he asked of You, You gave it to him—length of days forever and ever.'

[54] **Sanhedrin 107a**: The school of Rabbi Yishmael taught: 'Bathsheba daughter of Eliam was destined for David, but he consumed her while still unripe.'

[55] **Kisvei Rav Tzadok — Takanat HaShavin 6:82**: "And that is, as is known from the naturalists, that all begetting is only through desire; and when it is in the strength of the desire, the one born will be quick and full and wise, and therefore "most mamzerim are perceptive"; and if not with so much desire, he will be lazy and foolish; and without desire at all he will not beget at all. […] And so the Blessed Name willed that the formation of man be through desire, and that there be in him the inclination of desire from birth, and through this there will be place for free choice and for effort, and place for Torah, which is only through the inclination."
Source reading: The Akiva edition numbers this passage 6:82; it corresponds to Takanat HaShavin 6:75 in the Sefaria transcription. The original reads רובן, "most of them."

[56] **Shabbos 56a**: 'Rav said: When you examine David, you find nothing in him except the matter of Uriyah, as it is written, "Except in the matter of Uriyah the Chitti" (I Kings 15:5).'
Abbreviation: The abbreviation מש״ל in the base text is read here as "what I wrote above," following the immediate context.

[57] **Isaiah 11:13**: 'And the envy of Ephraim shall depart, and the adversaries of Yehudah shall be cut off; Ephraim shall not envy Yehudah, and Yehudah shall not harass Ephraim.'

[מִזֶּה הַמְּלוּכָה, מַה שֶּׁאֵין כֵּן בְּעֵשָׂו הוּא מְכַלֶּהוּ וְשׁוֹרְפוֹ, אֲבָל הַמְּלוּכָה הִיא הַכְבִישָׁה].[58] **— Hence Joseph's monarchy began over the gentile nations who belong merely to this temporary world, specifically over Egypt —the "nakedness of the land" (Genesis 42:9) steeped in unbridled licentiousness—ruling by being their polar opposite [subduing and governing them, whereas with Esau he completely destroys and burns him, since kingship means subjugation].** וִיהוּדָה מָלַךְ עַל אֶחָיו, שֶׁהוּא מְלוּכָה שֶׁלְּעוֹלְמֵי עַד, רַק אַחַר מְכִירַת יוֹסֵף הוֹרִידוּהוּ מִגְּדֻלָּתוֹ כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ רַבּוֹתֵינוּ זִכְרוֹנָם לִבְרָכָה עַל פָּסוּק: "וַיֵּרֶד [יְהוּדָה מֵאֵת אֶחָיו]".[59] **— Whereas Judah ruled over his own brethren, an everlasting sovereignty; yet following the sale of Joseph the brethren demoted him from his greatness, as the Sages expounded on "and Judah went down from his brethren" (Genesis 38:1; Sotah 13b).** וְאָז הָלַךְ לִשָּׂא אִשָּׁה, וְאָמְרוּ חֲכָמֵינוּ זִכְרוֹנָם לִבְרָכָה עַל פָּסוּק: שֶׁעָסוּק בְּאוֹרוֹ שֶׁל מָשִׁיחַ.[60] **— And then he went to take a wife, concerning which our Sages said (Bereishit Rabbah 85:1): while the brothers were occupied with the sale, the Holy One was creating the light of the Messiah.**

Mashiach ben David Revealed Only After the Slaying of Mashiach ben Yosef; Sun and Moon

וְהַיְנוּ כִּי גִּלּוּי מָשִׁיחַ בֶּן דָּוִד הוּא רַק אַחַר הֲרִיגַת מָשִׁיחַ בֶּן יוֹסֵף, שֶׁהֵם דְּגֻמַּת חַמָּה וּלְבָנָה [כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּרֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה (דַּף כ״ה עַמּוּד א׳): וּשְׁלַח לִי סִימָנָא וְכוּלֵי, כַּנּוֹדָע][61] **— For the full revelation of Mashiach ben David occurs only after the passing of Mashiach ben Yosef, who represent the Sun and the Moon [as stated in Rosh Hashanah (25a): "David, King of Israel, is alive and enduring," matching the moon]** [שֶׁזִּיו אִיקּוֹנִין שֶׁלּוֹ דּוֹמֶה לְאָבִיו שֶׁנִּקְרָא שֶׁמֶשׁ, וְגַם אֻמּוֹת הָעוֹלָם עוֹבְדֵי כּוֹכָבִים וּמַזָּלוֹת בָּעוֹלָם הַזֶּה; אֲבָל יַעֲקֹב דְּגֻמַּת אוֹר הַחַמָּה שֶׁלָּעָתִיד לָבֹא "כְּאוֹר שִׁבְעַת הַיָּמִים", וְיוֹסֵף הוּא רַק דּוֹמֶה לְאָבִיו, פָּרוּשׁ: מִצַּד הַדִּמְיוֹן בָּעוֹלָם הַזֶּה הוּא אוֹר שִׁבְעַת הַיָּמִים, אֲבָל לָעָתִיד אֵינוֹ כֵּן].[61] **— [For his countenance resembled his father's, who is called the sun, the idolatrous nations, too, [are associated with the sun] in this world. Jacob, however, resembles the future sunlight, "like the light of the seven days." Joseph only resembles his father: from the perspective of appearance in this world he is the light of the seven days, but in the future it is not so.]** וְאֵין הַלְּבָנָה מוֹשֶׁלֶת אֶלָּא אַחַר שְׁקִיעַת הַחַמָּה, וּמִקּוֹדֶם אֵין אוֹרוֹ נִכָּר עֲדַיִן, וְנֶחְלָקָה מִלְכוּת בֵּית דָּוִד, רַק הֲרִיגַת מָשִׁיחַ בֶּן יוֹסֵף הוּא הֶעְדֵּר כֹּחַ שָׁלִיטָתוֹ. **— And the moon does not shine with full dominion until the sun sets, its light being obscured beforehand; thus the death of Mashiach ben Yosef marks the cessation of that specific temporary mode of martial authority.** וְהַיְנוּ כְּשֶׁיִּגִּיעַ הַשָּׁעָה לִהְיוֹת "נִבְלַע הַמָּוֶת לָנֶצַח", וְיִסְתַּלֵּק עִנְיַן הֲרִיגָתָה מֵהָעוֹלָם. **— Namely, when the hour arrives for "death to be swallowed up forever" and the concept of killing vanishes entirely from creation.** וְאָז הַמִּשְׁפָּט שֶׁיִּסְתַּלֵּק גַּם כֵּן כֹּחַ הֲרִיגָתָה הַקְּדוֹשָׁה שֶׁבְּיוֹסֵף, וְלָכֵן יַהֲרֹג גַּם הוּא וְיִסְתַּלֵּק מִן הָעוֹלָם. **— Then justice requires that even the sanctified warfare of Joseph must cease; therefore he falls and departs from the world.**

וְאָז נִסְתַּלֵּק מִן הָעוֹלָם אוֹר הַחַמָּה שֶׁל יוֹסֵף וְכֹחוֹ שֶׁהוּא בִּרְצִיחָה דְּקְדֻשָּׁה נֶגֶד עֵשָׂו, שֶׁדָּבָר זֶה כְּבָר אֵינוֹ בָּעוֹלָם. **— And then the solar light of Joseph and his holy wrath against Esau departs, for such conflict has no place in the perfected world.** וְאָז יִזְרַח אוֹר מָשִׁיחַ בֶּן דָּוִד, וְהוּא יְחַיֵּהוּ לְמָשִׁיחַ בֶּן יוֹסֵף, וּ"פָּנִים חֲדָשׁוֹת בָּאוּ לְכָאן", אַחַר תְּחִיַּת הַמֵּתִים נַעֲשָׂה בְּרִיָּה חֲדָשָׁה, שֶׁאֵין בּוֹ עוֹד כֹּחַ הִתְנַשְּׂאוּת זוֹ שֶׁעַל יְדֵי מַדְרֵגָתוֹ הַנִּזְכֶּרֶת לְעֵיל. **— Thereupon the light of Mashiach ben David will shine forth, and he will resurrect Mashiach ben Yosef as "a new creation," devoid of any separate dominion or martial pride.** וּלְכָךְ לֹא יְקַנֵּא עוֹד אֶת יְהוּדָה, וְיוֹדֶה בְּמָשִׁיחַ בֶּן דָּוִד. **— Therefore he will no longer envy Judah, but will fully acknowledge Mashiach ben David.** וּלְכָךְ נֶאֱמַר: "וְהִבִּיטוּ אֵלַי אֵת

---

[58] **Genesis 42:9**: 'And Yosef remembered the dreams that he had dreamed about them, and he said to them: You are spies; you have come to see the nakedness of the land.'

[59] **Sotah 13b**: 'Rabbi Elazar says: They also lower him from his greatness, as it is written, "And it was at that time that Yehudah went down" (Genesis 38:1).'

[60] **Bereishis Rabbah 85:1**: 'The tribes were occupied with the sale of Yosef, Yosef was occupied with his sackcloth and his fast, Reuven was occupied with his sackcloth and his fast, Yaakov was occupied with his sackcloth and his fast, and Yehudah was occupied with taking a wife; and the Holy One, blessed be He, was occupied creating the light of the King Messiah.'

[61] **Rosh Hashanah 25a**: 'Rabbi told Rabbi Chiya: "Go to Ein Tav and sanctify the new month, then send me the sign: David, king of Israel, lives and endures."'

אֲשֶׁר דָּקָרוּ" (זְכַרְיָה י״ב, י׳) וְגוֹמֵר, שֶׁנִּקְרֵאת הֲרִיגַת מָשִׁיחַ בֶּן יוֹסֵף עַל שֵׁם יִשְׂרָאֵל.[62] **— And therefore it is said: "And they shall look upon Me whom they have pierced" (Zechariah 12:10; Sukkah 52a), attributing the death of Mashiach ben Yosef to Israel.** וְהַיְנוּ שֶׁכָּל הִשְׂתַּדְּלוּת יִשְׂרָאֵל לְתַקֵּן עָטְיוֹ שֶׁל נָחָשׁ וּלְהִתְבַּלַּע הַמָּוֶת, וּמִצַּד זֶה מַגִּיעַ הַהֲרִיגָה לְבֶן יוֹסֵף [כְּמוֹ הֲרִיגָה לַיֵּצֶר הָרָע הַנִּזְכָּר שָׁם וְכַנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל] כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל, וּמֵאֲלֵיהֶם דְּקָרוּהוּ. **— For Israel's entire effort is to rectify the instigation of the Serpent and swallow up death, and by that very accomplishment the martial role of Joseph's son is ended [akin to the slaying of the Evil Inclination recorded there], so it is as if they pierced him.**

The Sale of Yosef: "Master of Dreams," Imagination, and the World of Falsehood

וְכָךְ הָיָה גַּם כֵּן מְכִירַת יוֹסֵף, שֶׁקָּרְאוּהוּ "בַּעַל הַחֲלֹמוֹת".[63] [64] **— And such was the inward essence of the sale of Joseph, when the brothers called him "the master of dreams" (Genesis 37:19).** פַּרוּשׁ: בַּעַל דְּמְיוֹן, כִּי הַחֲלוֹם הוּא דְּמְיוֹן, וְנִמְשָׁךְ גַּם כֵּן מֵהִרְהוּרֵי הַלֵּב בַּיּוֹם. **— Meaning: a master of imagination (*dimyon*), for a dream is imagination, drawn from the waking reflections of the heart.** וּלְפִי שֶׁהֵם הִשִּׂיגוּ עַד הַסּוֹף וְרָאוּ שֶׁאֵין מֶלֶךְ רַק יְהוּדָה, וּלְכָךְ חָשְׁבוּהוּ לְבַעַל דְּמְיוֹן בִּמְלוּכָתוֹ. **— And because the tribes perceived the ultimate end and saw that eternal kingship belongs solely to Judah, they viewed Joseph's royal aspirations as a passing illusion.** אֲבָל בֶּאֱמֶת הַדְּמְיוֹן נִמְשָׁךְ מִן הַזִּמָּה כִּידוּעַ, כִּי "דְּמְיוֹן" פֵּרוּשׁ מַחֲשָׁבָה שֶׁל שֶׁקֶר שֶׁאֵינָהּ רַק בַּמֹּחַ וְלֹא מִתְקַיֶּמֶת בַּפּוֹעַל. **— But in reality imagination stems from illicit desire (*zimah*), imagination denoting a false mental construct residing merely in the brain without enduring actuality.** וְכֵן זְנוּת שֶׁאֵינוֹ לְשֵׁם מִצְוָה וְלִפְרוֹת וְלִרְבּוֹת נִקְרֵאת "שֶׁקֶר", כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב: "עָרֵב לָאִישׁ לֶחֶם שֶׁקֶר" (מִשְׁלֵי כ׳, י״ז) וְכַנּוֹדָע.[65] **— And so lust that is not for a mitzvah or procreation is called "falsehood," as written: "Bread of falsehood is sweet to a man" (Proverbs 20:17).** וְהוּא נִמְשָׁךְ מִן הַמֹּחַ כִּידוּעַ, לְכָךְ מִצַּד הַזֶּה הוּא מַחֲשֶׁבֶת הַדְּמְיוֹנוֹת שֶׁבַּמֹּחַ. **— And it stems from the brain; wherefore from this side proceed deceptive illusions of the mind.** וְיוֹסֵף הָיָה שׂוֹנֵא זִמָּה, לֹא הָיָה בַּעַל דְּמְיוֹן, רַק מִכָּל מָקוֹם הֲרֵי מַלְכוּתוֹ רַק לְפִי שָׁעָה שֶׁהוּא דְּמְיוֹן. **— Yet Joseph abhorred licentiousness and was no dreamer of vanity; nevertheless, his sovereignty was temporary, which is categorized as *dimyon*.** וְכֵן כָּל הָעוֹלָם הַזֶּה נִקְרָא "עָלְמָא דְּשִׁקְרָא" וְדִמְיוֹן, וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב: "בְּשׁוּב [הַשֵּׁם אֶת שִׁיבַת צִיּוֹן] הָיִינוּ כְּחֹלְמִים".[66] **— For this entire world is called a World of Falsehood and illusion, as written: "When Hashem brings back the captivity of Zion, we shall be like dreamers" (Psalms 126:1).**

רַק שֶׁבָּעוֹלָם הַזֶּה הוּא נִדְמֶה לָאֱמֶת, וְכָךְ שׂוֹנֵא זִמָּה בָּעוֹלָם הַזֶּה נִדְמֶה לָאֱמֶת — רָצָה לוֹמַר שֶׁכָּךְ הוּא הָרָאוּי לִהְיוֹת בִּרְצוֹן הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ, אֲבָל זֶהוּ מִצַּד הַחֵטְא. **— But in this world illusion appears as reality, and so hating unchastity appears as the supreme ideal, whereas that stance is necessary only as a defense against sin.** אֲבָל קוֹדֶם שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "וַיִּהְיוּ [שְׁנֵיהֶם] עֲרוּמִים... וְלֹא יִתְבּוֹשָׁשׁוּ" (בְּרֵאשִׁית ב׳, כ״ה).[67] **— Yet prior to the Fall it is said: "And they were both naked... and were not ashamed" (Genesis 2:25).** וְכֵן נֶאֱמַר בְּיַעֲקֹב: "הָבָה אֶת אִשְׁתִּי" וְגוֹמֵר, וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ חֲכָמֵינוּ זִכְרוֹנָם לִבְרָכָה: אֲפִילּוּ קַל שֶׁבַּקַּלִּים [אֵינוֹ אוֹמֵר כֵּן], אֶלָּא [כְּדֵי לְהַעֲמִיד תּוֹלָדוֹת].[68] **— And so said Jacob:**

---

[62] **Sukkah 52a**: ‘According to the one who says it is for Mashiach son of Yosef, who is killed, this is what is written: “And they shall look to Me because of him whom they have pierced, and they shall mourn for him as one mourns for an only son” (Zechariah 12:10).’

[63] **Kisvei Rav Tzadok — Likkutei Maamarim, Upon Completion of Talmud 8**: “And in the Gemara, Sanhedrin (30a) and the first chapter of Berachos (6b), “the master of the dream” is the angel who brings the dream, and not the person who dreams; but in truth Yosef is “the master of dreams,” as mentioned above, for the dream is to repair the sin of wasting seed while awake.”

[64] **Genesis 37:19**: ‘And they said one to another: Behold, this master of dreams is coming.’

[65] **Proverbs 20:17**: ‘Bread of falsehood is sweet to a man, but afterward his mouth will be filled with gravel.’

[66] **Psalms 126:1**: ‘A song of ascents. When Hashem returns the captivity of Tziyon, we will be like dreamers.’

[67] **Genesis 2:25**: ‘And they were both naked, the man and his wife, and they were not ashamed.’

[68] **Genesis 29:21**: ‘Jacob said to Laban: Give me my wife, for my days are complete, and I shall come to her.’ **Rashi**: ‘I am already eighty-four years old; when shall I establish the twelve tribes? That is why he said, “I shall come to her.” Even the most disreputable person would not speak this way, but he said it in order to bring forth offspring.’ **Bereishis Rabbah 70:18**: ‘Rabbi Aibu said: Even a dissolute man would not speak in such language. Rather, so he said to him: The Holy One, blessed be He, told me that I will raise up twelve tribes; now I am eighty-four years old,

"Give me my wife... that I may go in unto her" (Genesis 29:21), of which the Sages remarked (Bereishit Rabbah 70:18): even the most vulgar person would not speak so, yet Jacob did so purely to raise up holy tribes. כִּי קוֹדֶם הַחֵטְא, וְכֵן לֶעָתִיד לָבֹא, וְכֵן יַעֲקֹב אָבִינוּ שֶׁמְּצִדּוֹ הָיָה הַתִּקּוּן הַגָּמוּר וְאֵין שְׁלִיטָה לָרָע כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל, וּדְלֵכֵן לֹא מֵת כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל, אֵין שַׁיָּךְ כְּלָל לוֹמַר "שׁוֹנֵא זִמָּה", כִּי אֵין זִמָּה בָּעוֹלָם כְּלָל. — **For prior to sin, as in the World to Come and with Jacob our father—in whom rectification was complete, over whom evil had no dominion and who therefore did not die—the very concept of "hating licentiousness" does not apply, because licentiousness does not exist at all.**

וְהוּא דַּרְגָּא דְּדָוִד הַמֶּלֶךְ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם, וְאוֹיְבָיו דִּבְּרוּ עָלָיו שֶׁבָּא עַל אֵשֶׁת אִישׁ, וְכֵן יָרָבְעָם הוֹכִיחַ אֶת שְׁלֹמֹה. — **And this is the level of King David, concerning whom his adversaries slandered that he took a married woman, just as Jeroboam rebuked Solomon.** וְכֵן יוֹסֵף הוֹצִיא דִּבַּת אֶחָיו: נוֹתְנִים עֵינֵיהֶם בִּבְנוֹת הָאָרֶץ — הַיְנוּ מִצַּד דַּרְגָּא דִּילֵיהּ "שׁוֹנֵא זִמָּה", שָׁנָא זֶה.[69] — **And so Joseph brought evil report of his brothers that they cast their eyes upon the daughters of the land (Bereishit Rabbah 84:7), viewing it through his specific attribute which despised unchastity.** אֲבָל מִצַּד דַּרְגָּא דִּיהוּדָה אֵין זֶה זִמָּה כְּלָל, שֶׁהוּא תִּקּוּן חֵטְא הַנָּחָשׁ כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל. — **But from the perspective of Judah this was not licentiousness at all, being the holy transformation of the Serpent's instigation.** וְנִמְצָא מַה שֶּׁלֹּא הָיָה יוֹסֵף בַּעַל דִּמְיוֹן הוּא גַּם כֵּן רַק מִצַּד הַדִּמְיוֹן, וְלָכֵן קְרָאוּהוּ "בַּעַל הַחֲלֹמוֹת". — **Thus Joseph's very freedom from illusion was itself relative to the world of illusion; wherefore the brothers called him "the master of dreams."** וְלָכֵן הִתְנַכְּלוּ לַהֲמִיתוֹ, שֶׁחָשְׁבוּ שֶׁכְּבָר הֵם בִּשְׁלֵמוּת הַתִּקּוּן, שֶׁיִּתְאַבֵּד הַדִּמְיוֹן הוּא גַּם כֵּן רַק מִצַּד הַדִּמְיוֹן, וְשֶׁיִּהְיֶה עֵת קֵץ, אַחַר שֶׁתִּקְנוּ עִנְיַן דִּינָה שֶׁהוּא חֵטְא הַנָּחָשׁ, וְעַשָּׂו נִפְרַד מֵהֶם. — **Therefore they conspired to slay him, believing they had already achieved final rectification, wherein illusion would vanish and the End of Days would arrive, having rectified the affair of Dinah and separated from Esau.** וּלְכָךְ דַּוְקָא שִׁמְעוֹן וְלֵוִי, שֶׁהֵם אֲחֵי דִּינָה כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל וַחֲפֵצִים בְּתִקּוּנָהּ כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל, הֵם הַמִּתְנַכְּלִים לַהֲמִיתוֹ בְּיִחוּד: — **Wherefore Simeon and Levi, who were Dinah's brothers zealous for her rectification, were specifically the ones who plotted to put him to death.**

Yaakov Has No Tranquility in This World; the Wine and the Dregs, and R' Elazar ben Durdaya

וְכָךְ חָשַׁב יַעֲקֹב שֶׁבִּקֵּשׁ לֵישֵׁב בְּשַׁלְוָה.[70] — **And Jacob thought likewise when he sought to settle in tranquility.** וְיָדוּעַ שֶׁעֵשָׂו וְיַעֲקֹב חָלְקוּ בֵּינֵיהֶם, וְאֵין מַגִּיעַ לְיַעֲקֹב כְּלָל שַׁלְוָה בָּעוֹלָם הַזֶּה. — **For it is known that Esau and Jacob divided the realms, and Jacob has no portion of tranquility in this world.** רַק מִצַּד מַדְרֵגַת דָּוִד וּשְׁלֹמֹה, שֶׁבִּימֵיהֶם כְּבָר הִתְחִיל הַיְשִׁיבָה בְּשַׁלְוָה: "אִישׁ תַּחַת גַּפְנוֹ וְתַחַת תְּאֵנָתוֹ" (מְלָכִים א ה׳, ה׳).[71] — **Except from the perspective of David and Solomon, in whose days peaceful rest commenced: "every man under his vine and under his fig tree" (I Kings 5:5).** וְהַגְּמָר הוּא מָשִׁיחַ, שֶׁבְּיָמָיו יִהְיֶה תַּכְלִית הַשַּׁלְוָה וְהַמְּנוּחָה כִּמְפֹרָשׁ בַּכְּתוּבִים. — **And the ultimate fulfillment belongs to the Messiah, in whose days peace and rest will reach absolute completion, as explicitly recorded in Scripture.** וְהַיְנוּ כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּמָגִלָּה (דַּף י״ב עַמּוּד ב׳): זִיל לְגַבֵּי עַמּוֹן וּמוֹאָב דְּיָתְבֵי בְּדַכְתַּיְיהוּ כְּחַמְרָא עַל דּוּרְדְּיָא וְכוּלֵי, עַיֵּן שָׁם.[72] — **Matching Megillah (12b): "Go look at**

---

and if I do not raise them up now, when will I raise them up?'

69 **Bereishis Rabbah 84:7**: '"And Yosef brought an evil report of them" (Genesis 37:2). What did he say?… Rabbi Shimon says: They hang their eyes upon the daughters of the land.… [The Holy One, blessed be He, said to him:] You said they hang their eyes upon the daughters of the land—by your life, I will incite the bear against you: "And his master's wife lifted her eyes" (Genesis 39:7).'

70 **Kisvei Rav Tzadok — Kometz HaMinchah 2:25:1**: "That Yaakov sought to reach the level of the World to Come, to taste the fruit of his deeds in this world, as he had at the end, as stated in Tanna DeVei Eliyahu Rabbah ch. 3: "life without pain and without the evil inclination — how?" etc.; "his agitation sprang upon him" etc., for he still needed further preparation of fear, and this is "his agitation," in the sense of "a person should always agitate" etc. (Berachos 5a)."

71 **I Kings 5:5**: 'And Yehudah and Israel dwelt securely, each man under his vine and under his fig tree, from Dan to Be'er Sheva, all the days of Shlomo.'

72 **Megillah 12b**: 'They said to him: Since the day the Temple was destroyed and we were exiled from our land, counsel has been taken from us, and we do not know how to judge capital cases. Go to Ammon and Moav, who sit in their place like wine settled on its lees.'
Megillah 12b: 'And they told him the reason, for it is written, "Moav has been at ease from his youth, and he has settled on his lees, and has not been emptied from vessel to vessel, nor has he gone into exile; therefore his taste

Ammon and Moab, who sit securely in their place like wine settled on its dregs," see there. וּבַתּוֹסָפוֹת הקְשׁוּ: דְּהָא הֶגְלָם סַנְחֵרִיב; אֲבָל הַכָּאנָה כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּפֶרֶק חֵלֶק: וְכִי אֻמּוֹת הָעוֹלָם אֵין גּוֹלִים? אֶלָּא דְּאֵין גָּלוּתָם גָּלוּת, עַיֵּן שָׁם.[73] — **And Tosafot objected that Sennacherib exiled them; yet the meaning is as stated in Sanhedrin: do the nations not go into exile? Rather, their exile is not a true shattering exile.** וְדָבָר זֶה הוּא בָּעַמּוֹן וּמוֹאָב בְּיִחוּד, שֶׁאֲצָלָם הוּא תִּקְוֵי מִדָּה זוֹ שֶׁל שַׁלְוָה וּמְנוּחָה [שֶׁמִּצַּד הַזֶּה נִמְשָׁךְ כְּדָרְךָ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בְּפֶרֶק אֵין עוֹמְדִין: מַה יַּעֲשֶׂה הַבֵּן שֶׁלֹּא יֵחָטֵא], רַק שֶׁהֵם "כְּחֻמְרָא עַל דּוּרְדְּיָא".[74] — **And this quality is uniquely embodied in Ammon and Moab, who possess the essence of peaceful complacency [which fosters lust, as the Sages remarked: "What shall the son do and not sin?" (Berakhot 32a)], except that they are "like wine settled upon its dregs."**

פֵּרוּשׁ: "דּוּרְדְּיָא" הוּא הַזְּנוּת שֶׁבָּהֶם, כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתַבְתִּי בְּמָקוֹם אַחֵר עַל רַבִּי אֶלְעָזָר בֶּן דּוּרְדְּיָא הַנִּזְכָּר בַּעֲבוֹדָה זָרָה (דַּף י"ז עַמּוּד א').[75] [76] — **The meaning: *durdya* (dregs) represents the unrefined sexual lust within them, as I wrote elsewhere regarding Rabbi Eleazar ben Durdaya (Avodah Zarah 17a).** שֶׁאָמְרוּ חֲכָמֵינוּ זִכְרוֹנָם לִבְרָכָה בִּמְגִלָּה (דַּף ט"ו עַמּוּד א'): כָּל מָקוֹם שֶׁנָּזְכַּר שְׁמוֹ וְשֵׁם אָבִיו, וְגַם כָּאן זָכְרוּ שֵׁם אָבִיו.[77] — **For the Sages stated in Megillah (15a) that wherever both a person's name and his father's name are cited, his father was righteous; and here too his father's name is emphasized.** וְאִיתָא בִּבְרָכוֹת (דַּף ז' עַמּוּד ב'): "אֲשֶׁר שָׂם שַׁמּוֹת [בָּאָרֶץ]" — אַל תִּקְרֵי שַׁמּוֹת אֶלָּא שֵׁמוֹת, שֶׁהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרֵךְ שָׂם הַשֵּׁם בָּאָרֶץ הַמּוֹרֶה עַל הַמְּהוּת.[78] — **And in Berakhot (7b): "Who has made desolations (*shamot*) in the earth"—read not *shamot* but *shemot* (names), for Hashem places names that reflect essential nature.** וְכָךְ שְׁמוֹ "דּוּרְדְּיָא", וְרַבִּי אֶלְעָזָר בְּנוֹ הוּא חַמְרָא דְּעַל דּוּרְדְּיָא, וְזָכָה לְהַפְרִישׁ הַיַּיִן מִן הַשְּׁמָרִים עַל יְדֵי הַמִּיתָה. — **Thus his name was Durdaya (dregs), and Rabbi Eleazar his son was the wine resting upon the dregs, who merited separating the pure wine from the sediment through death.** שֶׁנִּקְרָא בְּכָל מָקוֹם בְּדִבְרֵי רַבּוֹתֵינוּ זִכְרוֹנָם לִבְרָכָה "דָּנָח נַפְשֵׁיהּ", כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב: "שָׁם רְשָׁעִים חָדְלוּ רֹגֶז" וְגוֹמֵר, שֶׁשָּׁם הַנִּיחָא וְהָעִדֵּר הָרֹגֶז.[79] — **Death being termed by the Sages "his soul rested" (*d'nach nafshei*), matching: "There the wicked cease from troubling, and there the weary are at rest" (Job 3:17).** אֲבָל בָּעוֹלָם הַזֶּה וּבַחַיִּים אִי אֶפְשָׁר לְהַפְרִישׁ בֵּינֵיהֶם רַק עַל יְדֵי מָשִׁיחַ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר בּוֹ: "חַיִּים שְׁאַל" וְגוֹמֵר, שֶׁיִּהְיֶה תַּכְלִית הַנִּיחָא וְנִבְדָּל מִדּוּרְדְּיָא. — **But in this world and in physical life it is impossible to separate the wine from the dregs except through the Messiah,**

---

remains in him and his scent has not changed" (Jeremiah 48:11).'

[73] **Eichah Rabbah 1:28**: '"Judah was exiled." Are the nations not also exiled? Although they are, their exile is not truly exile. The nations eat their bread and drink their wine, so their exile is not truly exile. Israel, who do not eat their bread or drink their wine, experience true exile. The nations walk in their footwear, so their exile is not truly exile; Israel, who walk barefoot, experience true exile.'

[74] **Berachos 32a**: Rabbi Chiya bar Abba said in Rabbi Yochanan's name: 'This is like a man who had a son, bathed and anointed him, fed him and gave him drink, hung a purse around his neck, and seated him at the entrance to a brothel. What could that son do to avoid sinning?'

[75] **Kisvei Rav Tzadok — Machshavot Charutz 8:6**: "but the penitent breaks through every kind of boundary, and in one hour and one moment can acquire his world; and not only that, but they call him "Rabbi," like Rabbi Elazar ben Durdaya (Avodah Zarah 17a), which is above the measure and rung of human attainment, that he can attain and come in one moment from being sunk in the utmost darkness to great light."

[76] **Avodah Zarah 17a**: A baraita teaches: 'They said of Rabbi Elazar ben Dordaya that he left no prostitute in the world with whom he had not had relations. Once he heard of a prostitute in the coastal cities who charged a purse of dinars. He took such a purse and crossed seven rivers to reach her. During intercourse she passed wind and said: "Just as this wind will not return to its place, so Elazar ben Dordaya will not be accepted in repentance." He went and sat between two mountains and hills,' etc. 'He said: "The matter depends only upon me." He placed his head between his knees and wept aloud until his soul departed. A heavenly voice proclaimed: "Rabbi Elazar ben Dordaya is destined for the life of the World to Come."'

[77] **Megillah 15a**: 'Ulla said: Wherever his name and his father's name are stated in prophecy, it is known that he is a prophet son of a prophet.'

[78] **Berachos 7b**: 'From where do we know that a name has an effect? Rabbi Eliezer said: For the verse says, "Come, behold the works of the Lord, who has made desolations (shamos) in the earth" (Psalms 46:9)—do not read shamos, "desolations," but shemos, "names."'

[79] **Job 3:17**: 'There the wicked cease from troubling, and there the weary are at rest.'

of whom it is said "he asked life of You," attaining consummate rest while separated from the dregs. אֲבָל בָּעוֹלָם הַזֶּה: דְּפָרֵישׁ מִזְּנוּת — מָיֵת, כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב שָׁם בַּעֲבוֹדָה זָרָה. **— In this world, whoever completely tears himself away from lust dies, as recorded of Eleazar ben Durdaya in Avodah Zarah.**

וְהֵם הָיוּ בָּאֻמָּת בַּעֲלֵי זְנוּת שֶׁהוּא שִׁמְרֵי הַיַּיִן — רָצָה לוֹמַר פְּסֹלֶת הַנִּמְשָׁךְ מִן הַשַּׁלְוָה בָּעוֹלָם הַזֶּה, שֶׁדּוֹמֶה לְיַיִן שֶׁמְּמַגּוּ נִמְשָׁךְ הַשַּׁלְוָה, כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב: "יַיִן יְשַׂמַּח [לְבַב אֱנוֹשׁ]" וְגוֹמֵר.[80] **— And Ammon and Moab were immersed in lust, which is the sediment of wine—the coarse dross emerging from worldly ease, likened to wine which induces tranquility: "wine makes glad the heart of man" (Psalms 104:15).** וְ"יֵשׁ שׁוֹתֶהוּ וְטוֹב לוֹ" (בְּרָכוֹת דַּף נ"ז עַמּוּד א'): הַיְנוּ בְּלֹא הַשְׁמָרִים, וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (יוֹמָא דַּף ע"ו עַמּוּד ב'): חַמְרָא פִּקְחִין — הַיְנוּ שֶׁשַּׁלְוָה שֶׁלּוֹ עַל פִּי הַתּוֹרָה, כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב: "פִּקּוּדֵי [הַשֵּׁם יְשָׁרִים] מְשַׂמְּחֵי לֵב".[81] [82] **— And "one drinks it and it is good for him" (Berakhot 57a)—which is wine without dregs, matching Yoma (76b): "wine sharpens the mind," meaning tranquility guided by Torah: "the precepts of Hashem are right, rejoicing the heart" (Psalms 19:9).** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (הוֹרָיוֹת דַּף י' עַמּוּד ב'): מִי סָנֵי לְצַדִּיקֵי דְּאָכְלֵי תִּרֵי עָלְמָא?[83] **— And matching Horayot (10b): "Is it hateful to the righteous to enjoy two worlds?"** וְהוּא מִצַּד הַתּוֹרָה, כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב: "בִּשְׂמֹאולָהּ — עֹשֶׁר וְכָבוֹד", וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ חֲכָמֵינוּ זִכְרוֹנָם לִבְרָכָה: כָּל זְמַן שֶׁ"הַקּוֹל קוֹל יַעֲקֹב" — אֵין "הַיָּדַיִם [יְדֵי עֵשָׂו]".[84] **— Proceeding from the Torah, as written: "in her left hand are riches and honor" (Proverbs 3:16), and: as long as "the voice is the voice of Jacob," the hands of Esau cannot prevail.** וְ"יֵשׁ שׁוֹתֶהוּ וְרַע לוֹ" (בְּרָכוֹת שָׁם) — הַיְנוּ עִם הַשְׁמָרִים, רָצָה לוֹמַר תַּאֲוַות הָעוֹלָם הַזֶּה הַנִּמְשָׁכִים וּמְחֻבָּרִים לְבַעַל שַׁלְוָה כְּמוֹ עַמּוֹן וּמוֹאָב. **— And "one drinks it and it is bad for him"—which is drinking with the dregs, meaning the worldly lusts that attach to unrestrained ease, as seen in Ammon and Moab.**

וּמֵהֶם הוּא צְמִיחַת בֶּן דָּוִד הַמַּשִּׁיחַ שֶׁלְּוָה בָּעוֹלָם **— And out of them sprouts the Son of David who establishes true peace in the world** [וְכֵן נְקֵבוֹתֵיהֶם מֻתָּרוֹת כִּי הֵם בַּעֲלֵי מְנוּחָה, כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב: "כָּל כְּבוּדָּה בַת מֶלֶךְ פְּנִימָה", וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב: "נָשִׁים שַׁאֲנַנּוֹת... בָּנוֹת בּוֹטְחוֹת", וְהוּא לְשֶׁבַח כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּבָבָא קַמָּא (פֶּרֶק הַמַּנִּיחַ), וְכֵן דָּוִד הַמֶּלֶךְ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם וּמָשִׁיחַ דַּרְגָּא דְּנוּקְבָא כְּנִזְכָּר לְעֵיל][85] [86] **— [and their females were permitted because they possess inner repose: "all glorious is the king's daughter within" (Psalms 45:14), and "carefree women, confident daughters" (Isaiah 32:9), which is praiseworthy, David and the Messiah embodying the receptive female rung (*Nukva*) as noted above],** שֶׁיְּפָרִישׁ הַיַּיִן הַמְשֻׁמָּר בַּעֲנָבָיו מִשֵּׁשֶׁת יְמֵי בְּרֵאשִׁית, שֶׁזֶּהוּ תַּכְלִית הַשֵּׁשֶׁת יְמֵי בְּרֵאשִׁית — הַיְנוּ הַבְּרִיאָה — לְהַגִּיעַ לְיוֹם הַשַּׁבָּת שֶׁהוּא נִקְרָא יוֹם הַמְּנוּחָה, נִיחָא וְשַׁלְוָה. **— who will separate the wine preserved in its grapes since the Six Days of Creation, the ultimate purpose of Creation being to reach the Sabbath Day—the day of rest, serenity, and holy tranquility.** וְאָז יִתְגַּלֶּה אוֹתוֹ יַיִן כִּי יִפָּרוֹשׁ מִן הַשְׁמָרִים, וְיִהְיֶה שׁוֹתֶהוּ וְטוֹב לוֹ. **— And then that sacred wine will be unveiled, entirely separated from the dregs, becoming "one drinks it and it is good for him."** מַה שֶּׁאֵין כֵּן אָדָם הָרִאשׁוֹן, לְחַד מַאן דְּאָמַר (סַנְהֶדְרִין דַּף ע' עַמּוּד א') גֶּפֶן הָיָה, הָיָה שׁוֹתֶהוּ וְרַע לוֹ, כִּי תַּאֲוָה הוּא חֵטְא עוֹלָם, שָׁנָה, נָפַשׁ כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל:[87] **— Unlike Adam the First, who according to one**

---

[80] **Psalms 104:15**: 'And wine gladdens the heart of man, making the face shine more than oil, and bread sustains the heart of man.'

[81] **Berachos 57a**: 'All kinds of drinks are good for a dream except wine: there is one who drinks it and it is good for him, and there is one who drinks it and it is bad for him. One drinks it and it is good for him—as it is said, "And wine gladdens the heart of man" (Psalms 104:15); one drinks it and it is bad for him—as it is said, "Give strong drink to one who is perishing, and wine to the bitter of soul" (Proverbs 31:6).'

[82] **Yoma 76b**: 'Rava pointed out a contradiction: It is written yeshamach (makes desolate) and we read yesamach (gladdens): if he merits, it gladdens him; if he does not merit, it makes him desolate. And this is what Rava said: Wine and fragrances make me wise.'

[83] **Horayos 10b**: 'Rava said: If the righteous enjoy two worlds, is that hateful to them?'

[84] **Proverbs 3:16**: 'Length of days is in her right hand; in her left hand are riches and honor.'

[85] **Psalms 45:14**: 'All the glory of the king's daughter is within; her garment is of settings of gold.'

[86] **Isaiah 32:9**: 'Women at ease, rise up, hear my voice; confident daughters, give ear to my speech.'

[87] **Sanhedrin 70a–b**: 'Rabbi Meir says: That tree from which Adam the first man ate was a vine, for there is nothing that brings wailing upon a person but wine.'

Sage in Sanhedrin (70a) ate from the grapevine, drinking it to his detriment, for untamed desire corrupted Space, Time, and Soul, as explained above.

Why Yosef's Agitation Sprang Upon Yaakov; the Interdependence of the Two Mashiachs

וְחָשַׁב יַעֲקֹב כִּי כְּבָר הִגִּיעַ לַהַפְרָשָׁה הַגְּמוּרָה, הוּא זְמַן הַשַּׁלְוָה, וְקָפַץ רָגְזוֹ שֶׁל יוֹסֵף כְּנִזְכָּר לְעֵיל.[88] — **And Jacob thought that he had already arrived at the absolute separation (of holy wine from unholy dregs), which is the season of tranquility, whereupon the agitation of Joseph pounced upon him, as noted above.**

דְּרוּגְנָא הוּא הַפֶּךְ הַשַּׁלְוָה, וּלְעוֹלָם הָרוּגְנָא וְרִתְחָא דְּרַבָּנָן נִמְשָׁךְ מִיּוֹסֵף, וְשַׁלְוָה לַצַּדִּיקִים נִמְשָׁךְ מִדָּוִד כְּנִזְכָּר לְעֵיל. — **For agitation (*rugza*) is the antithesis of tranquility, and spiritual wrath—the fiery zeal of Torah scholars (*ritcha d'rabbanan*)—eternally derives from Joseph, whereas tranquility for the righteous derives from David, as noted above.**

וְתִקּוּנָם תָּלוּי זֶה בָּזֶה. — **And their mutual spiritual rectifications are interdependent.**

כִּי לוּלֵי חֵטְא יָרָבְעָם, הָיָה נִכְנָע תַּחַת בֵּית דָּוִד כְּשֶׁבָּאוּ לְבֵית הַמִּקְדָּשׁ לָרֶגֶל, וְנִמְצָא לֹא נֶחְלְקָה מַלְכוּת בֵּית דָּוִד. — **For had Jeroboam not sinned, he would have bowed in submission under the House of David when coming to the Temple for the pilgrimage festivals, and consequently the Davidic monarchy would never have split.**

וְאִלּוּלֵי חֵטְא שְׁלֹמֹה וְהִגִּיעַ הַמִּשְׁפָּט לֵיחָלֵק מִבֵּית דָּוִד, לֹא חָטָא יָרָבְעָם, רַק זֶה גּוֹרֵם זֶה. — **And had Solomon not sinned, bringing about the divine decree of division from the House of David, Jeroboam would not have sinned; rather, each catalyzed the other.**

וְכֵן לוּלֵא חֵטְא יוֹסֵף בְּרוּגְזָא שֶׁלֹּא בִּמְקוֹם הָרָאוּי, דְּהֵיְנוּ עַל אֶחָיו שֶׁהֵבִיא דִּבָּתָם רָעָה, רַק הָיָה שׁוֹפֵךְ חֲמָתוֹ עַל הָעוֹבְדֵי כּוֹכָבִים וּמַזָּלוֹת [אָז הָיָה כָּלָה בָּאֱמֶת בֵּית עֵשָׂו לְגַמְרֵי], וְלֹא מְכָרוּהוּ אֶחָיו, וְהָיָה גְּמַר הַיְשׁוּעָה אָז. — **Likewise, had Joseph not erred through misplaced wrath directed against his own brothers by bringing their evil report, but instead poured his indignation exclusively upon the idolatrous nations [whereupon the house of Esau would indeed have been completely annihilated], his brothers would not have sold him, and the final redemption would have arrived then.**

כִּי אִי אֶפְשָׁר לוֹ לְכַלּוֹת אֶת עֵשָׂו רַק כַּאֲשֶׁר יִהְיֶה הָרִתְחָא וְלֶהָבָה שֶׁלּוֹ בְּרוּרָה וּנְקִיָּה מִכָּל פְּסֹלֶת, שֶׁאֵינוֹ כּוֹעֵס אֶלָּא עַל מִי שֶׁהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרֵךְ חָפֵץ לְכָעוֹס. — **For it is impossible for Joseph to consume Esau unless his zeal and burning flame are completely purified and refined of all dross, so that he rages only against whom Hashem desires to express wrath.**

וְהָיָה נִכְלָה הַכַּעַס הָרָע, הַיְנוּ שֶׁנֶּגֶד רְצוֹן הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרֵךְ אֶצְלוֹ לְגַמְרֵי, אָז מְמֵילָא הָיָה נִכְלָה עַל יָדוֹ גַּם כֵּן הַרְצִיחָה הָרָעָה מִן הָעוֹלָם לְגַמְרֵי. — **And had all tainted anger—anger contrary to Hashem's Will—been utterly expunged within him, all evil murder in the world would automatically have been annihilated through him forever.**

אֲבָל בֶּאֱמֶת רַק נִפְרַשׁ עֵשָׂו וְנִתְרַחֵק מֵהֶם, אֲבָל לֹא נִכְלָה לְגַמְרֵי. — **Yet in reality Esau merely withdrew and distanced himself from them, without being completely eradicated.**

וּלְכָךְ גַּם כֵּן עַל יְדֵי זֶה הִגִּיעַ גַּם כֵּן לִהְיוֹת מִגְּדֻלָּתוֹ, שֶׁגַּם הוּא לֹא הִשְׁלִים מַדְרֵגָתוֹ עֲדַיִן לְגַמְרֵי, וְהִגִּיעַ הַמַּחֲלֹקֶת בְּמַלְכוּת בֵּית דָּוִד. — **Therefore, through this failing, Judah was likewise brought down from his greatness, as he too had not yet brought his own spiritual rung to absolute completion, leading eventually to discord within the Davidic monarchy.**

כִּי גַּם מַה שֶּׁיֵּשׁ לְיוֹסֵף כַּעַס וְדִבָּה רָעָה נֶגֶד אֶחָיו, הוּא מִצַּד מַחֲשַׁבְתּוֹ שֶׁחוֹשֵׁב שֶׁבֶּאֱמֶת נוֹתְנִים עֵינֵיהֶם בִּבְנוֹת הָאָרֶץ. — **For Joseph's anger and harsh report concerning his brothers stemmed from his belief that they were indeed casting their eyes upon the local Canaanite women.**

וּמִנַּיִן הִגִּיעַ לוֹ מַחֲשָׁבָה זוֹ? עַל כָּרְחָךְ שֶׁיֵּשׁ אֵיזֶה מַמָּשׁוּת בַּדָּבָר, שֶׁעֲדַיִן לֹא תִּקֵּן יְהוּדָה לְגַמְרֵי עִנְיַן הַמְּלוּכָה שֶׁלּוֹ שֶׁהִיא הָעִדֵּר הַזִּמָּה לְגַמְרֵי. — **And whence did such a suspicion occur to him? Perforce there was some subtle trace of reality to it, because Judah had not yet completely rectified his royal domain—the total transcendence of licentious blemish.**

כִּי אָז הַכֹּל יוֹדוּ שֶׁאֵינוֹ רָע, בִּפְרָט יוֹסֵף שֶׁחָפֵץ בֶּאֱמֶת כִּרְצוֹן הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרֵךְ, מֵאַיִן נִמְשַׁךְ לוֹ טָעוּת? רַק מִכֹּחַ יְהוּדָה. — **For had it been consummate, all would have recognized that no evil was present, especially Joseph who sincerely desired only Hashem's Will; whence could his misjudgment arise if not from an unrectified residue in Judah?**

אֲבָל מִכָּל מָקוֹם הַטָּעוּת הוּא אָצְלוֹ וְאֵינוֹ מְתֻקָּן לְגַמְרֵי, בְּאֹפֶן שֶׁתִּקּוּנָם זֶה תָּלוּי בָּזֶה, וּתְרֵין מְשִׁיחִין תְּכוּפִים זֶה אַחַר זֶה, כִּי תִּקּוּן שְׁנֵיהֶם בִּמְהֵרָה בְיָמֵינוּ אָמֵן. — **Nevertheless, the misjudgment rested with**

---

[88] **Kisvei Rav Tzadok — Machshavot Charutz 7:15**: "That although he sought to dwell in tranquility after the birth of all the tribes, for he saw the building of the whole structure of the Congregation of Israel in his seed and thought it had already been clarified, the agitation of Yosef sprang upon him — the agitation that comes from the level of Yosef, who brought an evil report of them, to show that there were still lacks in them that needed clarifications; and through this, of itself, Yaakov himself also needed clarifications."

Joseph, showing that he was not yet fully rectified; thus the rectification of each depends on the other, the two Messiahs following consecutively, their joint fulfillment arriving speedily in our days, Amen. — וּלְעוֹלָם קִלְקוּל הָאֶחָד גּוֹרֵם גַּם כֵּן קִלְקוּל לָאַחֵר, וּלְכָךְ הֲרוּגָּא דְּיוֹסֵף קָפִץ עַל יַעֲקֹב לְהַעְדִּיר הַשַּׁלְוָה מִצַּד רוּגְזָא דְּיִלֵיהּ. **And flaw in one invariably induces flaw in the other; wherefore the agitation of Joseph pounced upon Jacob, stripping away tranquility through Joseph's misplaced anger.**

וְהֵינוּ כִּי בֶּאֱמֶת הוּא הָיָה הָעִקָּר וְהַמַּקְדִּים, כְּמִפֹּרָשׁ בַּכָּתוּב שֶׁהֵבִיא דִּבָּתָם רָעָה.[89] — **For in truth Joseph was the primary instigator who preceded the rift, as stated explicitly in Scripture: "and Joseph brought an evil report of them unto their father" (Genesis 37:2).** וְתֵדַע, שֶׁהוּא קִבֵּל הָעֹנֶשׁ יוֹתֵר בַּמְּכִירָה, וּמִכָּל מָקוֹם הָיָה גַּם בִּיהוּדָה חִסָּרוֹן, רַק שֶׁהוּא מִתְעוֹרֵר מִיָּד לְתַקֵּן וְהִצִּילוֹ מִמִּיתָה. — **Know this to be true, for Joseph bore the greater punishment through being sold into slavery; yet a flaw was found in Judah as well, except that Judah roused himself immediately to rectify it and rescued him from death.** כִּי אִלּוּ חַס וְשָׁלוֹם הֲמִיתוּהוּ, לֹא הָיָה תִּקְוָה לִיהוּדָה גַּם כֵּן, כִּי הֵם תְּלוּיִים זֶה בָּזֶה כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל. — **For had they slain him, God forbid, there would have been no future hope for Judah either, their destinies being completely intertwined, as noted above.** וְהֵם חָשְׁבוּ שֶׁהוּא גְּמַר הַתִּקּוּן, וּבֶאֱמֶת לֹא הָיָה כְּלָל כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל, רַק יְהוּדָה רָאָה כִּי עֵשָׂו לֹא נִכְלָה לְגַמְרֵי רַק נִתְרַחֵק, וְחָשְׁבוּ שָׁכָךְ הוּא גְּמַר הַתִּקּוּן. — **And the brothers presumed this marked the ultimate rectification, which was not the case; rather, Judah perceived that Esau was not destroyed but only distanced, and they imagined that distancing alone constituted the final perfection.** לְכָךְ הַמִּשְׁפָּט גַּם לְיוֹסֵף, שֶׁהוּא מִדַּת הָרְצִיחָה דִּקְדֻשָּׁה, לְהִתְרַחֵק לְפִי שָׁעָה גַּם כֵּן בַּמְּכִירָה, וְלֹא בְּמִיתָה לְגַמְרֵי לְפִי שָׁעָה. — **Wherefore justice decreed that Joseph—the embodiment of sanctified combat—should likewise be merely distanced for a time through being sold, rather than put to death completely.** וּבֶאֱמֶת זֶה הָיָה טָעוּת בְּשָׁעָה שֶׁחָשַׁב שֶׁהוּא מִצִּדּוֹ מְתֻקָּן לְגַמְרֵי בְּמַדְרֵגָתוֹ, וּבֶאֱמֶת אֵינוֹ עַד "כִּי יָבֹא שִׁילֹה".[90] — **And truly it was an error for anyone to believe that he had achieved complete rectification within his own level, for it cannot be complete until Shiloh (the Messiah) arrives (Genesis 49:10).**

The Sale as Yehuda's Flaw and Yosef's Descent; the Birth of Mashiach's Light

וְנִמְצָא הָיָה מְכִירָה זוֹ קִלְקוּל דִּיהוּדָה, וְגָרַם אַדְּרַבָּא קִלְקוּל לְיוֹסֵף, שֶׁכָּל עִקַּר קְדֻשַּׁת רְצִיחָתוֹ הוּא לְפִי שֶׁאֵינָנּוּ מִזִּמָּה רַק מִשְּׂנְאַת זִמָּה כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל. — **Thus this sale was an imperfection in Judah, which conversely brought spiritual detriment to Joseph, whose entire sanctified wrath was pure only because it derived from hating licentiousness rather than from base passion.** וְהוּא הוּרַד לְמִצְרַיִם — מָקוֹם הַזִּמָּה כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל, וְאִי אֶפְשָׁר לְמִי שֶׁבִּמְקוֹם מְטֻנָּף שֶׁלֹּא יִתְטַנֵּף קְצָת — **And he was cast down into Egypt—the very bastion of unchastity—and it is impossible for one immersed in a foul place not to contract a measure of defilement** [וְלָכֵן אָמַר מֹשֶׁה רַבֵּנוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם: "כְּצֵאתִי אֶת הָעִיר אֶפְרֹשׂ [אֶת כַּפַּי אֶל הַשֵּׁם]" (שְׁמוֹת ט׳, כ״ט), כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ חֲכָמֵינוּ זִכְרוֹנָם לִבְרָכָה, וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתַבְתִּי בְּמָקוֹם אַחֵר].[91] [92] — **[wherefore Moses our teacher said: "As soon as I go out of the city, I will spread forth my hands unto Hashem" (Exodus 9:29; Shemot Rabbah 12:5), refusing to pray amid Egypt's abominations, as I wrote elsewhere].** וְכֵן הוּא קָלַט קְצָת, וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ חֲכָמֵינוּ זִכְרוֹנָם לִבְרָכָה (שַׁבָּת דַּף מ״ט עַמּוּד ב׳) עַל פָּסוּק: "וַיָּבֹא [הַבַּיְתָה] לַעֲשׂוֹת מְלַאכְתּוֹ" (בְּרֵאשִׁית ל״ט, י״א), וְזֶהוּ קִלְקוּל לְדַרְגָּא דִּילֵיהּ.[93] [94] — **And so Joseph**

---

[89] **Genesis 37:2**: '…Yosef, seventeen years old, was shepherding the flock with his brothers… and Yosef brought an evil report of them to their father.'

[90] **Genesis 49:10**: 'The scepter shall not depart from Yehudah, nor the lawgiver from between his feet, until Shiloh comes, and to him shall be the gathering of peoples.'

[91] **Shemos Rabbah 12:5**: '"And Moshe said to him: When I go out of the city I will spread out my hands" (Exodus 9:29)—from here, that Moshe did not wish to pray within Egypt, because it was filthy with idols and abominations.'

[92] **Kisvei Rav Tzadok — Resisei Layla 57:3**: "And the beginning of the arousal of the Chashmonaim, according to what we say in the Yotzer for Chanukah, was over this: that their sister should not be violated by the governor."

[93] **Shabbos 49b**: 'Rav Yosef asked: "And he came into the house to do his work (melachto)" (Genesis 39:11)—is it of the count [of the thirty-nine labors] or not?'
Sotah 36b: '"And he came into the house to do his work." Rav and Shmuel: One says: To do his work in the plain sense; and one says: He went in to do his needs.'

[94] **Sotah 36b**: 'It is written: "On that day he came into the house to do his work." Rabbi Yochanan said: This teaches

absorbed a subtle trace, as the Sages noted on: "and he went into the house to do his work"—he entered with intent to satisfy his desire (Sotah 36b; Shabbat 49b), which was a spiritual descent for his high level. וְכֵן הִגִּיעַ קִלְקוּל לְדַרְגָּא דִיהוּדָה בְּמִיתַת אִשְׁתּוֹ וּבָנָיו, שֶׁהוּא הֵפֶךְ "חַיִּים שָׁאַל [מִמְּךָ]" וְגוֹמֵר.[95] **— And likewise a flaw befell Judah's attribute through the death of his wife and two sons (Er and Onan), which was the antithesis of "he asked life of You" (Psalms 21:5).**

וְהִנֵּה הֵם חָשְׁבוּ שֶׁעַל יְדֵי מְכִירַת יוֹסֵף יִתְרוֹמֵם קֶרֶן יְהוּדָה לִהְיוֹת תַּכְלִית הַשְׁלֵמוּת. **— And behold, the brothers had calculated that through selling Joseph the glory of Judah would be exalted, ushering in ultimate tranquility and consummate perfection.** אֲבָל כְּשֶׁרָאוּ אֶבְלוֹ שֶׁל יַעֲקֹב, וְאַדְרַבָּא דָּבָר זֶה מָנַע הַשַּׁלְוָה, וְנִתְגַּלָּה וְנִתְבָּרֵר שֶׁאַדְרַבָּא עַל יְדֵי זֶה גָּרְמוּ קִלְקוּל יוֹתֵר, לְכָךְ הוֹרִידוּהוּ מִגְּדֻלָּתוֹ, שֶׁרָאוּ שֶׁעֲדַיִן אֵינוֹ בַּשְׁלֵמוּת הַגְּדוֹלָה, וְעַל כֵּן יֵשׁ חִסָּרוֹן בּוֹ. **— But when they witnessed Jacob's inconsolable mourning, discovering that this act had banished tranquility and wrought grave spiritual damage, they demoted Judah from his leadership, perceiving that he had not attained supreme perfection and harbored flaws.** וְכֵן מִצַּד הַמְּכִירָה נִגְרַם חִסָּרוֹן יוֹתֵר, וְנִגְרַם הוֹרָדָתוֹ מִגְּדֻלָּה. **— And thus through the sale an even deeper deficiency was manifested, precipitating his descent from greatness.** וְאָז גַּם יְהוּדָה הִתְחִיל לָשׁוּב וּלְהִתְחָרֵט כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ רַבּוֹתֵינוּ זִכְרוֹנָם לִבְרָכָה, וְאָז הִתְחִיל אוֹרוֹ שֶׁל מָשִׁיחַ הָאֲמִתִּי שֶׁהוּא לַעֲשׂוֹת שָׁלוֹם בָּעוֹלָם, וְאִי אֶפְשָׁר כְּלָל שֶׁיִּהְיֶה קְטָטָה וּמַחֲלֹקֶת מִמֶּנּוּ [רַק הַמַּחֲלֹקֶת הָרִאשׁוֹן בֵּין יִשְׂרָאֵל הָיָה מִיּוֹסֵף בְּסִבָּה רָעָה כִּי הוּא מִצַּד מִדָּתוֹ, וְכֵן יָדוּעַ שֶׁמִּצַּד שֶׁנֶּחְלְקָה מַלְכוּת בֵּית דָּוִד הוּא הַמַּחֲלֹקֶת בָּעוֹלָם, וְהוּא עַל יְדֵי יָרָבְעָם].[96] **— And then Judah began to repent and express remorse (Sotah 13b), at which moment the light of the true Messiah began to emerge—he whose essence is to establish peace throughout the world, from whom strife and discord can never proceed [for the initial rift among Israel stemmed from Joseph's accusatory report according to his attribute, just as global discord arose when the Davidic throne was divided through Jeroboam].**

וְשֶׁיִּהְיֶה מִצַּדּוֹ מְכִירַת יוֹסֵף מִצַּד שִׂנְאָתוֹ, וְהִכִּיר בָּזֶה חִסָּרוֹנוֹ [כְּעִנְיַן חֵטְא דָּוִד בִּדְבַר אוּרִיָּה הַחִתִּי, כָּךְ חֵטְא יְהוּדָה וְחִסָּרוֹנוֹ בָּאֱמֶת לֹא הָיָה אֶלָּא בָּזֶה שֶׁגַּם הוּא שָׂנָא לְיוֹסֵף], דְּחַס וְשָׁלוֹם שֶׁיִּהְיֶה הֲרִיגַת מָשִׁיחַ בֶּן יוֹסֵף עַל יְדֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל, רַק עַל יְדֵי גּוֹג וּמָגוֹג שֶׁהוּא הַהֵיפֶךְ שֶׁל מָשִׁיחַ בֶּן דָּוִד לְגַמְרֵי כִּידוּעַ.[97] **— And that Judah should have participated in the sale of Joseph out of personal enmity, in which he now recognized his fault [akin to David's single flaw regarding Uriah the Hittite, so was Judah's solitary fault that he harbored animosity toward Joseph], for God forbid that Mashiach ben Yosef should be slain by Israel; he will be slain only by Gog and Magog, who represent the absolute antithesis of Mashiach ben David.** וּלְכָךְ כְּשֶׁשָּׁב מִשִּׂנְאָתוֹ, אָז הוּא בְּרִיאַת אוֹרוֹ שֶׁל מָשִׁיחַ,[98] וְאֵין כָּאן מָקוֹם לְהַאֲרִיךְ עוֹד, וְהָבֵן הֵיטֵב. **— Therefore, the moment Judah repented of his hatred, the light of the Messiah was born; and this is not the place to elaborate further, so understand this well.**

---

that both intended to commit a transgression.'

95 **Psalms 21:5**: 'Life he asked of You, You gave it to him—length of days forever and ever.'

96 **Mei HaShiloach, Volume I, Genesis, Vayigash 1** (excerpt): '"To me the Rock of Israel spoke": "to me" means to the penitent. To him God speaks particularly and gives strength after his sin, when it seems to him that hope has vanished. When he returns to Hashem, the Holy One gives him strength. Therefore the expressions differ: at first it says "said," a gentle expression, while concerning the penitent it says "spoke," signifying strength. At first it also says "God," and afterward "Rock," which likewise signifies strength and reinforcement.' Mei HaShiloach is discussing Yehudah's bold approach in Vayigash. It distinguishes the general command addressed to everyone from the personal strengthening given to the penitent after failure. Read beside Yehudah's descent here, it explains how acknowledging a flaw can lead to renewed approach to Hashem instead of despair.

97 **Sukkah 52a**: 'The Rabbis taught: To Mashiach ben David, who is destined to be revealed speedily in our days, the Holy One, blessed be He, says: Ask of Me anything and I will give it to you.… And once he sees that Mashiach ben Yosef was killed, he says before Him: Master of the world, I ask of You only life.…'

98 **Kisvei Rav Tzadok — Takanat HaShavin 11:4**: "And this is the attribute of kingship that Yehudah merited, who prevailed over his brothers in conquering the inclination, to confess after the sin; for this is reckoned more than the conquest of the inclination by Yosef, who conquered without any sin at all, and only one letter of the Name of the Holy One, blessed be He, was added to him; unlike Yehudah, who is called entirely by the Name of the Holy One, blessed be He, as is stated (Sotah 10b); for he merited that his sin be reckoned as a great merit—the creation of the light of Mashiach, which came forth from that deed; for there is no merit greater than this, and this is a greater might: that even the evil itself be turned into very good."